

A Detailed Commentary on the Praise Called 'Supremely Exalted'

Viśeṣastava-nāma-ṭīkā · Toh 1110 · Derge Tengyur

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Toh 1110 in the Tengyur is a Sanskrit and Tibetan scholarly commentary known in Sanskrit as the Viśeṣastava-nāma-ṭīkā and in Tibetan as the Khyad par du 'phags pa'i bstod pa'i rgya cher bshad pa, meaning "A Detailed Commentary on the Praise Called 'Supremely Exalted.'" It is an exegetical treatise belonging to the class of commentarial literature, providing an extended explanation of the celebrated hymn of praise to the Buddha composed by the Indian poet and scholar Mātṛceta, who is said to have converted to Buddhism from a brahminical background steeped in the four Vedas. The text opens with a verse of homage to Mañjuśrī and proceeds to illuminate the meaning of Mātṛceta's praise both through narrative context and close doctrinal exposition. As a commentary on a devotional hymn directed to the Buddha, it reflects the rich tradition of eulogistic and explanatory literature that developed around revered Sanskrit stotras within Indian Buddhist scholasticism.

In the language of India: Viśeṣastava-nāma-ṭīkā. In the Tibetan language: A Detailed Commentary on the Praise Called "Supremely Exalted."

Homage to the Blessed One Mañjuśrī, Ever Youthful.

Possessed of supreme distinction,
worshipped by the gods — to that buddha
I offer homage; this Praise Called "Supremely Exalted"
shall now be explained faithfully, according to its meaning.

There was a brahmin named Mātṛceta, learned in the four Vedas and held in highest esteem by the brahmin community. Having gained faith in the teaching of the Blessed One, he composed this praise dedicated to the buddha, the Blessed One. The account is as follows, as it has been heard in succession.

In the eastern region there was born, from the brahmin lineage that delights in the six brahminical duties, and from an excellent brahmin family, a pair of brothers. Through the power of virtuous conduct well-practiced in former lives, they came to be named Mātṛceta and Sukhakara. Both came to master all the treatises of their tradition. At that time the two of them thought: "In our

household the Great God (Śiva) is worshipped, and yet the scriptures of the buddha, the Blessed One, appear supremely excellent. Therefore we must carefully investigate whether it is the Great God who is supremely exalted, or whether it is the buddha, the Blessed One, who is supremely exalted."

The two of them had heard that the Great God was visibly present on Mount Kailāsa together with Umā and the best of bulls. They resolved that they would go there and do exactly as the Great God instructed them. With great effort and accompanied by divine helpers, they set out swiftly, and upon reaching the level ground of Mount Kailāsa, they beheld the Great God's finest bull reclining there, draped like a white patch of cloud. Seeing this, they were filled with great joy. Immediately after, they caught sight of the goddess Umā in a grove of fruit trees thick with hanging fruit, and they paid homage reverently. Then, hearing word that their lord was present in a grove where flowers bloomed in full, their minds overflowed with delight, and strewing scattered blossoms, they entered that lovely flower-carpeted ground, where they saw the Great God seated on a throne of great magnificence, surrounded by an assembly of a thousand attendants.

The very moment they saw him, the lord of the assembly took them by the hand and brought them before him, and they paid reverent homage. He then addressed them: "From where have you come?" he asked. The two of them told him everything in full. Then, as it was drawing near to the time for the monks' mealtime, five hundred arhats (Skt. arhat) descended from the sky like red-winged birds swooping down — clad in brownish, moisture-colored robes, dwelling on a cool-aired lake.

Thereupon the Great God, together with his retinue, took up incense, ointments, and articles of offering and went respectfully toward them. He had precious garments placed upon each of them as they sat upon their individual seats, and saw to their comfort; he satisfied them fully with food, drink, delicacies, and provisions. Umā too made offerings of flowers and fruit, and listened to teachings on the Dharma from those arhats. When the arhats had departed once more, the Great God spoke to the two brothers: "I know the purpose for which you have come here. I shall tell it to you.

The teacher whose disciples we joyfully honor every day, possessed of supreme qualities,
whose supremely excellent name, bearing the great quality of dispelling the world's faults, is widely renowned —

When making offerings with a mind of the greatest joy, one's thought becomes like nirvāṇa.

That buddha, teacher of the three worlds, possessing qualities without equal — the wise make offerings to him.

Therefore, you should make offerings to that very Teacher of yours and to his scriptural words.

Then, having come to understand this, the two brothers returned to their own land. Knowing that the scriptural Dharma of the Tathāgata is without fault, they cast aside the words of the Vedas like grass, went forth into renunciation, and composed two hymns of praise to the buddha, the Blessed One: the Praise of Eminent Distinction and the Praise Surpassing That of the Gods.

Now, wishing to explain the meaning of the limbs of the first verse, the text reads: "I, having abandoned other teachers" — and so forth.

If someone were to object: "Why do you, having understood the suchness of all the treatises in their entirety, abandon teachers such as the brahmins and naked ascetics and one-eyed mendicants and the like, together with the teachings established by them, and instead enter into the Blessed One, the buddha himself, and his teaching?" — it is in anticipation of this objection that the verse was spoken: "I, having abandoned other teachers, come to you, O Blessed One, for refuge. Why is this? Because you are without fault and endowed with qualities."

In this verse, "I" refers to the one who is himself making the praise. "Teacher" means one who tames and disciplines, and this refers to figures such as the brahmins and the like. "Having abandoned" means having fully relinquished and cast aside. "Blessed One" is a translation term: those afflictions — attachment and the rest, together with their habitual tendencies — that have been overcome are expressed by the word "overcome," and one who possesses that overcoming is the Blessed One. "You" refers to the buddha, the Blessed One.

As for what kind of being you are — the word "refuge" is spoken, meaning "support": that upon relying on which all misconduct is brought to exhaustion. "Come to" means "having gone to and entered." The meaning is that one who has accumulated many forms of misconduct — such as lack of faith and so forth — confesses them properly before the Blessed One, is thereby freed from those wrongs, and is born in the higher realms. Let this serve as the illustration.

As for what the reason is for abandoning other teachers and going for refuge to this Teacher — this is addressed by "Why is this?" and what follows. The meaning is: because you are free from faults and endowed with qualities. That which is free from the fault of habitual tendencies and the like is what is meant by "free from faults." A fault, moreover, is something that afflicts body, speech, and mind — that is to say, the mental afflictions themselves. "Qualities" are powers, fearlessnesses, and the like. One who possesses these without equal — that is "endowed with qualities," and that one is you.

If the Blessed One, the buddha, is himself without fault and endowed with supremely excellent qualities, then why do some people abandon the Blessed One and instead follow others such as the brahmins? For that reason the text states:

Because the people of the world delight in faults
and are attached to grasping at qualities,
they see faults themselves as qualities
and have gone for refuge to others.

Here "also" is a particle of analytical inquiry. "The world" means ordinary sentient beings — common people — for noble ones do not delight in faults. Moreover, that they are called "the world" in the specific sense is because they are attached to sense objects. "Delighting in faults" means finding pleasure in and being inclined toward things that are worthy of reproach. Alternatively, even though this world does not delight in faults as such —

— it means that they have entered into perceiving whatever is a fault as being a quality itself. For example: an eye afflicted by a bilious disease sees the beautiful white color of moonbeams as yellow, and thinks to itself, "We see and perceive the color as yellow." In just the same way, through the fault of associating with unwholesome spiritual friends and listening to what is not the true Dharma, the mind becomes confused, and one comes to grasp even faults as qualities themselves.

The phrase "attached to grasping at qualities" means: by taking up qualities, one grasps at qualities — this is the meaning of perceiving qualities. And to be diminished in that grasping at qualities is the meaning of being foolish and deluded.

Here, the phrase "delighting in faults" indicates that the mind-stream has been made impure by the fault of inverted perception. The phrase "seeing even

faults as qualities" indicates that beings, bereft of discernment and confused through conceptual thought, take hold of things in this way.

As for how one can confirm what was said before — the phrase "to others" and so forth is stated for this reason: because they have gone for refuge to others such as the Great God (Śiva), Viṣṇu, Brahmā, and the like. This verse teaches the following: because worldly people have no qualities and have accumulated many faults, they go for refuge to these others — and this shows with certainty that they desire a teacher other than the true one.

How is it, one might ask, that these others are possessed of faults and not possessed of qualities? The phrase "Viṣṇu" and so forth is then stated: "the lord of wealth and the great lord of power" is Viṣṇu, the powerful one; and whatever is included among them belongs to the class of Viṣṇu and the like. Now, a person who has faith in these — one who rejoices in them and is filled with pure devotion — proclaims whatever qualities they have and specifically extols whatever distinctions they possess: that, they say, is a fault in your teaching. The meaning is: in the teaching of you, the Blessed One, the buddha — that is a fault, a defect, an impoverishment, something worthy of reproach.

Then, since it is a fault in your teaching, what qualities of theirs are proclaimed? Beginning with the phrase "the Great God" and so forth, these are set forth. "The Great God wrathful" means: through a mind-stream pervaded by rage and fury. "The three-tiered city" means the three cities taken as one combined triple city — the destruction of that triple city — and he burned it with violence. The word "violently" indicates that this can be proclaimed as a quality. And indeed, the way in which the quality of the Great God is proclaimed and taught in the world is this: the three cities of the asuras (demigods) arose, traveling through the sky; the asuras then descended from them and caused harm to human beings. Thereupon the Great God, in order to protect the humans, took up his bow and with a single arrow burned the triple city of the asuras.

This is told just as it is said:

Here the city of the demigods roamed through the sky,
filled with men, women, the old, and the young.
Taking up the great bow, with a blazing arrow,
he burned it in an instant, as if burning it with fire.

Now, this — in your teaching — is called "taking life," and it is a great fault; for on account of it one falls into the hells. And it is said:

Whoever, seeing you, does not turn back from the act of taking life —
that extreme —

you all are now going to the hells —
alas, know that you are bound for such a fate.

So it is said in the sūtras.

Now, if burning the city of the asuras was a fault on his part, then what is the burning endowed with your qualities? To that question, the verse beginning "yours" and so forth is spoken. As for the weapon: it is "the great arrow of gnosis," for gnosis itself is the great arrow — and so it is by that. "The fire of wrath" means that wrath is like a mother, and so it is the fire of wrath — the meaning being that the Blessed One (the Buddha) thoroughly burned that very thing and brought it to quiescence.

Objection: is it not the case that it is the great sovereign power of loving-kindness that brings the fire of wrath to quiescence? For has not the Blessed One declared: "Monks, cultivate loving-kindness! Familiarizing oneself with loving-kindness, meditating on it, and making much of it, one comes to abandon aversion."

That is indeed so, yet loving-kindness only soothes and calms wrath at the surface, whereas gnosis uproots it entirely. This is why gnosis is spoken of here.

As for the line beginning "the Great God (Śiva) for his part," the fault of burning is the fault of having burned improperly — burned without uprooting. This is what is being taught: desire itself, because of the fault of burning it improperly, drew the Great God back and brought him under its power. And the account goes like this: at a certain time, on account of such deeds as burning the triple city, the Great God felt profound disenchantment and, in order to purify that fault, he dwelt in a cave in the cleft of a snow-capped mountain, abiding in ascetic observance. When the god of desire came to obstruct him, the Great God said: "Do not harm me." Yet the god of desire went ahead and harmed him — whereupon the Great God, tormented in mind with blazing wrath, from his third eye released a fire that left not even ashes of the god of desire. But then again the god of desire obstructed the Great God, ever overcoming him with the allure and coquetry of his queen's lower body. This is the meaning of the verse line:

By the fire of your gnosis —

that is, by the fire of your gnosis.

"Pulled out at the root" means leaving no remainder to be obtained — meaning together with all habitual tendencies.

"Burned and expelled" means cleared away in such a manner that it will never arise again.

As for the verse beginning "the Great God, toward the supreme Bindu maiden," the tradition tells us that two brothers among the asuras, named Sundhā and Upasundhā, appeared and propitiated Brahmā until the three worlds could not conquer them. They asked Brahmā: "Though our bodies are separate, make it so that our minds are not separate from one another." Brahmā granted this boon. The two then undertook to conquer the three realms. When the gods deliberated on how to kill these two, Brahmā said: "Make it so that they devise the means to kill each other." The gods each gave forth light in the measure of a sesame seed from their own bodies, and from that they fashioned a divine maiden called Tilalepī — the supreme Bindu maiden — and set her to circumambulate Brahmā. As Brahmā gazed upon her form with a mind utterly distracted by desire, he became embarrassed and manifested four faces. In just the same way, the Great God too, under the power of attachment, manifested four faces.

Hence the verse says:

The Great God, toward the supreme Bindu maiden,
through passionate attachment, gained four faces.

"The Great God" here is the one who possesses the three-pointed weapon. "The supreme Bindu maiden" is the divine maiden. "Having given rise to attachment" means entering into a mind possessed of passionate longing.

"Gained four faces" means: he became one possessed of four faces.

Furthermore, concerning the Blessed One, the verse says:

Through the coquetry of Māra's daughters,
not even the tip of a hair on your body stirs.

"Māra's daughters" are the daughters associated with Māra — namely Craving and Delight, together with their retinue. Their coquetry is characterized by laughing and speaking, casting sidelong glances, and performing alluring dances; yet even with all of that — "your" meaning you, the Protector — "not even the tip of a hair" of the limbs of your body stirs or changes. This teaches

that when the Blessed One was seated at the Vajrāsana, the seat of awakening, even at that stage of being an ordinary person, they were unable to arouse desire in him.

Regarding the verse "Half of the Great God" and so forth: "half" here means the lesser half of the body — the divine goddess Umā, whom he holds and embraces. Because of this he is called Ngurpa, though he strives and yet cannot prevail; for the reason is that they are beings with bodies distinct from one another. This is how it came about: when the Great God had been experiencing the pleasures of desire together with Umā for the span of a thousand years, the moment approached when he was about to emit the vital fluid. He thought: "For a while one side of the body has enjoyed the pleasures of desire on my behalf. Now, out of sheer pleasure, let her enter the other half of my body, the half that is my own, so that I may experience an extraordinary bliss." And so that half of the body came to be known as the sovereign lady of women. Furthermore, the verse says:

You who bring about bliss —

meaning: not becoming deluded by the very desire that causes delusion; the meaning is "not becoming bewildered and attached."

Regarding "the wheel-bearing one with the short spear" and so forth: he who possesses the wheel is the wheel-bearer — the meaning is Viṣṇu, who carries the discus as his weapon. The one with the short spear is the Great God, who carries the trident. "The power of Māra" is Māra's army of thirty-six million. "Victor" means one who overwhelms and cannot be brought under his dominion. The verse says:

Without your wheel and without your spear,
you conquer with whatever weapon is loving-kindness.

This teaches the following: in order to prevail over the power of Māra, even without the wheel of Viṣṇu and without the spear of the Great God, you prevail manifestly through the weapon of loving-kindness, and conduct yourself as one who has overcome them.

Regarding "the elder" and so forth: the verse says "the elder pierced Viṣṇu with an arrow." This is the story: the kinsmen and company of Viṣṇu were sitting and drinking beer in a certain place, when a sage happened to pass near that inauspicious spot. Viṣṇu, without restraint, thought: "I will taunt this sage." He transformed himself into the form of a woman, went before him,

paid him respectful homage, uncovered his belly and displayed it bound up with a strap, and said: "What is in this belly of mine? What will come forth from it?" The sage, perceiving through the power of his meditative concentration, became seized with intense and fierce anger, and cursed them all, saying: "From your womb may there come forth an iron pestle that destroys every last member of the lineage of Viṣṇu!" Then, not long after, an iron pestle came forth, and all the kinsmen of Viṣṇu came together. They ground that iron pestle down on stone and in water, and cast the filings into a pond of mud and reeds. And that, in turn, became a forest of reeds.

Now, from that iron pestle there remained one small piece, and thinking, "What harm can this do?" they threw it into the river. It was swallowed by a fish, and when it passed through, it entered the sea. A fisherman took it and sold it to an old hunter. When he cut open the fish, the iron piece came out, and he fastened it as the tip of an arrow.

Some time later, in fear of being struck by the curse, the kinsmen of Viṣṇu gathered on the bank of that pond and drank wine until they were intoxicated, and maddened by the curse, a great quarrel broke out among them. They began striking one another with the reeds growing there, and all the members of the lineage of Viṣṇu were utterly destroyed — all except for Viṣṇu himself, who was not present.

Viṣṇu, hearing of this, was unable to turn back the anguish in his mind. Grieving at heart, he went to a forest wilderness to dispel his sorrow. There, in the shade of an extremely dense tree, overwhelmed by grief, he lay with his entire body stretched out on the ground, his big toe moving. Now, it happened that the old hunter had entered the forest to track game, and was standing there intently watching for animals. When he saw the big toe moving, he thought it was the ear of a deer twitching, and shot an arrow — and that arrow deprived Viṣṇu of his life.

The word "old man" refers to the old hunter. The name "Viṣṇu" refers to the son of Brahmā. The phrase "by an arrow" refers to the arrow of the hunter. And "struck" means slain.

Now, regarding the line "the Great God (Śiva) whose throat turned blue":

The Great God refers to the mighty lord Śiva. His throat turned blue on account of his being struck by poison. This came about in the following way. When the gods entered into the churning of the ocean, at that time many things emerged from the sea — the jewel Kaustubha, the horse Uccaiṣravas,

and many others besides. Then a poison came forth, and by its power it settled within Viṣṇu's stomach and turned the color of his skin black. The Great God took that poison and, without fear, began to swallow it. But it became lodged in his throat, neither going upward nor going downward, and his throat appeared like the neck of a peacock. The gods said: "This is supremely beautiful — let it remain in his throat from this day forward." So, it is said, it came to be.

The phrase "these two gods" refers to Viṣṇu and the Great God. The phrase "there is one who does harm" means that there is one who abides with harm — that is, one who is accompanied by harm done by another, namely killing and injury. The address "O Protector" is addressed to the Blessed One, meaning "sovereign" or "lord." And "free from doing harm" means: because the Blessed One does no harm, he is free from harm-doing.

A question is raised: Although the Blessed One does not possess death brought about by another, he does nonetheless possess harm brought about by another — for a stone splinter struck his foot at Vulture Peak.

Here a response is given. That was merely a wound, and it cannot be called "harm" in the full sense. This is because harm is spoken of as an injury that persists over an extended duration, not something momentary. The Blessed One, in that very instant, experienced only that much, and it is not at all like the blueness of the throat of the Great God (Śiva). As for the verse beginning "Viṣṇu, having transformed into a short form" — the story is heard as follows. There arose an asura (demigod) named Balin, meaning "the Mighty One," and as he overcame his enemies he subjugated all three realms without exception. Viṣṇu then reflected: "I am unable to do battle with him, for he is endowed with exceedingly perfect heroic powers of a great being. Therefore I must certainly deceive him through a stratagem." With this in mind, he transformed himself into the appearance of a dwarf brahmin and adopted the guise of a beggar, then went forth. At the time when King Balin was engaged in the ritual of horse sacrifice, someone was calling out: "Who seeks what? To whom shall what be given?" Viṣṇu approached that one who was busy with this and said: "I make offering-fire for my father and mother, and for that purpose I beg a measure of land equal to one stride." Balin replied: "How could such a small thing fulfill your need? Instead, ask for elephants, horses, chariots, gold, and other goods — these I will give you without refusal and with distinction." Yet Viṣṇu was not satisfied. Then Balin said: "If that is truly all you want, at least take three strides." Whereupon Viṣṇu, with two strides, stretched one foot

across the expanse of the three worlds and, finding no place for the third stride, had reduced Balin to a state of having forfeited his pledge. Balin acknowledged forfeiture as the consequence of his broken vow, became despondent, and through great terror all his possessions were shattered. So Balin was seized and bound beneath the earth.

"Short" means having a short body. "Body" means the physical form. "Having transformed" means having visibly manifested. Who did this? Viṣṇu. Was it by overpowering his enemy? No — "by a stratagem of deception" is stated, meaning: by means of trickery. "The Mighty One" means the king of the asuras. "Was deceived" means: was made to fall from his kingdom.

Now, as for the thought that "you do not deceive others" — if one supposes that he does not deceive others because he does not know deception — the verse addresses this: "Yet he knows deception too." That is, because the Blessed One knows deception, the verse says "he knows deception too." The Blessed One being omniscient, he knows all things — both those that are afflicted and those that are unafflicted — yet whatever is afflicted he does not engage in. Here the sūtra of the Master holding a sword should be cited as an illustration.

As for the verse "O Protector, your miraculous powers" and so forth: your miraculous powers — O Protector, your miraculous powers — are those such as swift as thought, and the rest. His manifestation through them is his display. Of what kind? "Wondrous" — meaning: producing wonder and amazement. "Viṣṇu crossing the three worlds" means crossing the three worlds in three strides. "A creeper" means one without feet — moving by creeping it is a creeper — and because Viṣṇu moved like that, the phrase is "like a creeper." "Perceiving" means understanding. This will be taught as follows:

Whoever sees that wondrous display of your miraculous powers perceives even Viṣṇu's crossing of the three worlds — the divine realm and the underworld — as though a creeper were moving. Why is this so? Worldly people regard Jambudvīpa alone as the three worlds: the expanse between the two worlds enclosed by the four great oceans constitutes the world of humans; the foundation below is the world of the nāgas; the mountains such as the Himālayas, where the gods dwell, and the stars and so forth constitute the world of the gods. That which Viṣṇu crossed — this entire extent — is called "crossing the three worlds." But the Buddha, the Blessed One, by the mere

stirring of his intention, swiftly passes through world-realms of the great chiliocosm (Skt. trisāhasramahāsāhasra) numbering hundreds of thousands beyond reckoning, arriving at the world-realm of lights that has passed beyond them — through the miraculous power of swift-as-thought. It is to this that the analogy is to be applied.

As for the phrase "in youth, living the holy life" — Youth, Kārtika, the Cave-Dweller, and the Peacock-Rider are synonyms for the same one. "Living the holy life" means turning away from sexual conduct, practising the discipline that is free from the attachment of sensual desire. "Together" means at the same time and by the same means. Together with whom? With the Six-Marked One — that is his wife named the Six-Marked One. "Practising" means performing the conduct or guarding it.

This is the account as it has been heard. There arose a divine maiden called the Six-Marked One, surpassingly beautiful in form, skilled in conduct, devoted to the pleasures of the body, who surpassed others by the qualities of a woman. The youth took her as his wife. Thereupon a certain sage said to him: "If you desire victory over the three worlds and intend to proclaim a fame that is distinguished, then at this time you must practise the austerity called the Edge of the Sword. Know that this austerity is as follows: while you are in the bloom of youth and capable of experiencing sensual pleasure, you shall sport with her who is supremely beautiful and foremost among all your wives; you shall experience the pleasure of contact with her limbs and so forth, and yet you shall enter into equanimity between the two, making it as though there is no sensation. If this austerity is maintained for a long time, it will bear fruit." It was from that point forward that the youth undertook the austerity.

As for the phrase "you have turned sexual union into ashes" and the rest: "sexual union" means the joining of two with two. Because one has become joined in this way, it is sexual union — that is, engaging in and enjoying full copulation. Therefore "you have reduced it to ashes" means: having transformed what is not ashes into ashes, you have ruined it. This was also taught by the Blessed One in the sūtra on the seven forms of sexual connection:

"Among these brahmins there are some who claim to be celibate, who do not join with a woman two with two, yet who with their eyes look at a woman's form — the object of the eye — with intense fixation. They experience her, think upon her, and cling to her, and dwelling in that clinging — such a

brahmin, though calling himself celibate, is possessed of the quality of sexual union, not unpossessed of it. He practises an impure form of the holy life. He is broken, full of holes, corrupted, and stained. He is subject to birth, old age, sickness, death, grief, lamentation, suffering, mental anguish, and despair, and I declare that he will not be fully liberated from them, nor will he be freed from suffering.

Furthermore, one who with his eyes fixes his gaze with full concentration upon a woman — the object of the eye, upon visible form — and who then engages in playful talk and lighthearted banter together with her: that too is an impure form of the holy life, as before.

Furthermore, one who engages in such playful talk and lighthearted banter with a woman, and who also partakes of anointing, massaging, and bathing administered by a woman — that too is the same.

Furthermore, one who likewise appropriates even that which is not fully there, and who enjoys and listens to the ornaments, songs, dances, and other sounds of women separated from him by a wall or a screen — that too is the same.

Furthermore, one who engages in enjoying even just such sounds, and who, looking upon others endowed with the five qualities of sensory desire, partakes of their enjoyment, plays, and experiences happiness in taking pleasure — that too is the same.

Furthermore, one who engages in such enjoyment and who recalls past laughter, play, and joyful pleasures once experienced, and from that recollection makes them his own — that too is the same.

Furthermore, one who engages even in such recollection, and who dedicates his keeping of moral discipline, ascetic observances, austerities, or holy life to rebirth in a heavenly abode and the like — that holy life too is the same.

Thus the sūtra continues at length, saying: "A brahmin who has not abandoned and fully understood these seven forms of sexual connection — I declare he will not be able to pass beyond this world together with its gods."

Regarding the phrase "Brahmā and the rest are said to proclaim," the meaning is this: it is reported that they speak thus, saying, "Just as I cause the entire world of beings and the world as vessel to arise, so do I cause brahmahood to enter in." The word "said" indicates that this is merely something passed on as common report.

The phrase "the seer of suchness, you" means: one who possesses the vision and manner of seeing reality as it truly is — that one is the seer of suchness, meaning the omniscient one.

As for what that one taught: the commentary cites the words "the worlds, and their arising from karma," meaning that those worlds and whatever is said to give rise to them — Brahmā and the rest — you yourself have taught and declared to arise from karma.

And this has been taught in the sūtras: sentient beings are born from karma, they partake of the share of karma, they are connected with karma in succession. Whatever virtuous or non-virtuous karma they perform, they become the heirs of precisely that.

Regarding the verse "Śakra — the bearer of the vajra weapon, the lord — by Aśolā," and so forth: Śakra (Indra, the lord of the gods) means the one who bears the vajra as his weapon; the word "lord" carries that meaning. Aśolā is the daughter of a sage, and this arose from his having seen her. The word "desire" refers to the passion of the god of desire. "Bewilderment" means having fallen into confusion. The word "said" indicates this is a tale of the world.

The account is as follows: it was heard that there was a sage named Gautama who had a wife called Aśolā, endowed with the full bloom of youthful beauty. Śakra became attached to her, and she too became attached to him, and so the two of them became connected with each other.

On one occasion, the sage was invited as a guest to another hermitage, and went out to gather flowers, firewood, and kuśa grass. Śakra came there and was openly sporting with Aśolā, making love to her openly. Gautama returned to the hermitage without being fully aware of what had happened, and Aśolā, frightened, swallowed Śakra whole like a horse swallowing. Gautama then took Aśolā and went to visit the other hermitage to which he had been invited, and the sage, knowing by the power of his yogic insight exactly what had transpired, laid out three seats. Gautama thought, "Why are three seats being set out?" and upon examining the matter, he saw that Śakra was present within Aśolā's womb. Overcome with shame, he partook of the meal and returned to his own dwelling, and said to Aśolā, "Vomit Śakra out." And she did vomit him out. Then he cursed Śakra, saying, "May you be marked with a thousand vulvas." Whereupon the gods came there, pleased Gautama, and the curse was transformed as a boon: "May what you declared as a thousand

vulvas become a thousand eyes." And from that time forth he became one with a thousand eyes.

As for the words "O hero" and what follows: he is called a hero because he possesses the special quality of diligence. The address to the Blessed One as such means "O you who are heroic." The words "by desire itself" and "that delusion might be conquered" mean: for the sake of vanquishing desire. The words "sent away his queens" mean that he sent away and fully relinquished his retinue of sixty thousand queens, including Yaśodharā, Mṛgajā, Śāmtā, and the rest.

As for the words "by Rāhu's hand" and what follows: because he is seized by the hand of Rāhu himself, it is said "by the hand of Rāhu." The moon is marked by the hare. What kind of moon? It is a moon without power — deprived of strength and capability, without sovereignty, come under the power of another. "Seized" means "caught." This is in accordance with what was heard: when the gods churned the ocean of milk and the nectar of immortality arose, the asura Rāhu seized it and was about to consume it, whereupon Viṣṇu thought, "If he drinks this nectar, all the gods will be unable to overcome him," and severed his head with a discus. When Rāhu dropped the nectar, the gods took it back. The nectar had spread as far as the region of Rāhu's throat, so that though the lower portion of his body died, he remained alive; and he roams about to cause harm to gods and humans alike. It is from that time forth that he seizes the sun, which illuminates the three worlds, and the moon.

As for the words "who has lordship" and what follows: the meaning is that there is no sentient being or spirit whatsoever who is without your lordship over them and who acts harmfully toward you in dependence on another. As for the words "lord of men" and what follows: Priyaka and Vastranemin — these are those kings, one of whom returned from the forest of austerities, his mind moistened by sensual desire, and came back again to the household life. And this is how it was: King Daśaratha of the thirty-three-chariot company went to do battle with the asuras, and many spear-wounds of the asuras pierced his body. He went to the city of Avyūhā, and there his wife Kekayā nursed him back to health, and he in turn granted her a boon. Then on another occasion, when his father was about to consecrate Priyaka to royal sovereignty, Kekayā, her mind disturbed by envy of the royal sovereignty, said: "The gods pledged to grant me a boon,

"Grant me this boon: exile Rāma to the forest for twelve years, and consecrate my son Bharata to royal sovereignty." And so, while Rāma was in the forest, Rāvaṇa abducted Sītā, and Rāma slew Rāvaṇa and others, and then entered the wandering celestial palace called Puṣpaka. Bharata and the others made supplications and offerings, and the city passed without conflict, and Rāma reveled in pleasures and happiness.

Other kings too, such as Goṣṛṅga, seeing the world tormented and oppressed by suffering, and thinking "I too will come to such a condition as this," renounced their royal sovereignty and went to the forest. And again, having parted from that forest life, they fell into conduct unworthy of dwelling in this great earth, and all the people departed. With reverence they made supplications to invite those kings back once more to the royal palace, and those kings — their minds drawn back to delight in attachment and desire — returned again to the city. Thus did one hear it told.

"You, Sugata" is a mode of address.

"Solitude" — although physical solitude is also known by the word "solitude," here it is understood that the excellence of meditative absorption which produces both kinds of solitude is what is intended. That very solitude is the nectar of immortality, the deathless; and since you have drunk your fill of it and gone to the forest, you will not return again to the household life.

As for "sacrifice" and what follows: "sacrifice" means to make worship and to give in offering — the sacrifice of cattle and the like. "Slaughter of livestock" means the killing of animals such as cattle and horses. Who says such things? The verse runs: "The seers (ṛṣis) are said to proclaim it" — meaning that the ancient seers who ate the oblation flesh and such are said to have taught it thus.

"You, the faultless one" — one in whom there is no fault is the faultless one, and this is an address to you as such. "Even to the ant" — the ant is a creature of extremely small body. "Causing harm" means killing. "Did not teach thereafter" means: he did not say it thus, nor did he indicate that it should be done — that is the meaning.

Furthermore, the Sūtra of the Dharma-King says extensively: "That which none of you have seen — the inevitable end of those who do not turn back from the taking of life — I have certainly seen, either as a hell or in other states. Why is this? Because they have fully taken up and abide in the qualities that lead to hell."

As for "Others, for their own benefit" and what follows: sacrificial flesh-offerings and the like — others do these for their own benefit, meaning for their own advantage. By what means? Through the means of knowing sacrifice, through the method of sacrifice. "The life of another being" means: having cut off the life of another sentient being, they use it as the substance of the sacrifice and perform the sacrifice. This procedure of sacrifice, which involves harm to sentient beings, shows that by burning away one's own benefit, or rather by performing it as the cause of attaining the higher realms and the like, one brings one's own destruction near, just as it is said:

Seven thousand in the water,
eleven thousand in the fire —
the king's fasting, without food,
is of a number beyond count.

This was spoken by Bhīṣma on the field of battle.

Again, "You, O Protector, for the sake of others" means for the benefit of others. "You alone" means without companions. "By your own life" means by that very life of yours itself.

The phrase "performed the fire-offering" means that he made those things into the substances of a fire-offering, burned them, and thereby worked for the benefit of others. Here, the birth-story of the tigress and the like should be cited as an example.

Regarding the phrase "the sages' curse-fire": "sages" refers to the sages of old. "Curse-fire" means that the curse itself is like fire. How so? The phrase "unbearable" means that it is terrible. The phrase "many beings" means innumerable sentient beings. "Burned" means reduced to ash. This is as the Blessed One declared in the extended sūtra: "What do you think, assembled companions? Who was it that emptied and cleansed this forest hermitage of Mataka? O Gautama, it was by the unbearable curse of the sages' minds." And as for "You are the Blessed One" — "You" indicates the Blessed One, the Buddha. The phrase "by the fire of wisdom" means burned and reduced to ash by the fire of discernment. "Beings" refers to sentient beings. "The causes of arising" means karma and afflictions — those that have become the cause for the manifest increase of the things of the self — that is the meaning. Regarding the phrase "sages" and so forth, "accomplished in cursing" means possessing the power to curse. "Austerity" means ascetic practice. "Accomplished" means completed. "One may infer" means one can know. And

this is how: when someone has become capable of casting aside such curses, one can know that they are accomplished in their ascetic practice. When someone else is unable to cause harm and to curse others, they will not come to be renowned.

The phrase "O Protector" is an address to the Blessed One, the Buddha. The phrase "accomplished in compassion" means compassion fully perfected — that is, having reached the highest point of performing the benefit of others. In this regard, the activity of working for the benefit of others that is undertaken through loving care is called compassion. "Accomplished in that" means performing the activity of accomplishment — that is, performing the activity of benefiting others. "Accomplished in austerity" means the ascetic practice completed.

Regarding the verse beginning "The Great God (Śiva) who bears the mark of desire," this is what subsequently came to be heard: in a certain forest of palāśa trees, many sages were dwelling, afflicted by the most severe austerities, along with their sons, daughters, and wives. The goddess Umā, seeing the unbearable harshness of those sages' austerities, felt deep compassion for them all, and went to the presence of the Great God. In a private and relaxed setting she spoke these words: "These sages are striving in the practice of great austerities, desiring liberation, and so it seems fitting that you should indeed grant them the attainment of liberation." The Great God replied: "The bliss of liberation is attained by sentient beings through being free from attachment and aversion. These ones are not like that — how then can liberation certainly be conferred upon them?" Umā said: "Do not speak so. These beings are certainly free from aversion, so in every respect I present my petition — please satiate their bodies with the nectar of nirvāṇic bliss." Then the Great God, having ascertained Umā's mind with certainty, and feeling the force of desire arise in him toward the daughters of the sages, conceived the thought, "Let me arouse them for a while." On the second day, adorned with a garland of flowers upon his head, his body made firm and strong, dwelling in the fullness of youthful vigor and ornamented in garb of great allure, having rendered the substance of his own appearance young, and with his own mark uncovered, in a state of erection and emission, he went forth — and the sages' wives,

the throngs of young maidens born from the leaf-clusters of the trees — taking delight in touching and embracing his body, they entered into the groves of the śāla forest. And he, seeing that their minds were captivated, gazed upon

them in their great beauty, and through the power of desire the two sides of their thighs became drenched with flowing moisture, and their awareness grew greatly overwhelmed.

Then the sages born from the leaf-clusters, merely upon seeing this, were stirred into turbulent agitation by the force of their fury, and cursed him with these words: "May your member fall! May your member fall! — you, the untamed one, who through desire have caused it to rise!" Immediately thereafter, his member fell to the ground, like the tip of the great elephant of Śakra (Indra).

Now as to how it was that those women, by the power of their meditative concentration — the goddess said, "This is the Great God (Śiva); he has come here in order to awaken us" — knowing things just as they are, they took up that symbolic mark as something of essence and honored it with many and varied forms of excellent worship. It is from that time onward that in this world the worship of the symbolic mark came to be.

The Great God is the pleasure-maker. He is called "the one endowed with desire" because this conduct of the desirous one is present in him, for he engaged in desire together with the daughters of the sages. Alternatively, desire is the attachment of wanting, and the one in whom it resides is the one possessed of attachment. The mark is the male organ. "Of the sages" refers to those who dwell in the śāla forest. "By which," namely by the curse — "May your member fall! May your member fall!" — that is, by the harsh words arising from anger that was thoroughly stirred up. "Fell" means: it came down and struck the ground.

Furthermore, O Blessed One, awakened Buddha, it is you who have caused desire itself to fall — that is, you have abandoned the very attachment of wanting, along with its habitual tendencies. What kind of desire is this? It is said to be the root of the mass of harm and destruction. The very root of those masses of harm and destruction in this life and in other lives is desire itself. Concerning this, the Blessed One stated at length in a sūtra: "Through the cause of attachment, through the foundation of attachment, through the power of attachment, a mother and her son speak together constantly, and the son engages with the mother." And the master Aśvaghoṣa also said:

The world, bound by desire, is slain and swollen with conceit,
exhausted, terror-struck, and overtaken by manifold sufferings.
Lords of the earth have fallen by the very pursuit of desired ends,

openly crushing the Dharma, and in the next life going to hell.

Regarding "born from the grove" and so forth: "born from the grove" refers to the sage Vyāsa. The word "and so forth" is to be applied to Vālmīki, the author of the narrative of Rāma, and to others who composed other poetic works. "For the most part" means "in great number," indicating that there is a small portion among those which they examined by drawing inferences from their own experience. "What others have said" refers to whatever explanations opponents have given — those they repeat, and the people of the world delight in them. This is to say: what was declared by Vyāsa and so forth in the Bhārata and the rest is mostly a repetition of what others have already said.

Regarding "the Dharma not held in common by you" and so forth: "not held in common" means not declared by others. "Dharma" refers to the supreme teachings of scripture that fully illuminate the Four Noble Truths.

"Having realized it himself" means that he realized it through his own insight, without relying on instruction from others. This is just as it is extensively stated in the Sūtra of the Turning of the Wheel of Dharma: "O monks, regarding these phenomena never heard before, the understanding, the knowing, and the discernment arose in me: 'This is the noble truth of suffering.'"

"Taught" means that he caused it to be taught to others. This is just as it was declared: "All these categories of Dharma, which wander everywhere, are to be taught to other practitioners."

Regarding "of the tīrthikas" and so forth: "of the tīrthikas" means belonging to the non-Buddhists. What is that? It is the Vedic words — the various other texts of the non-Buddhists. "Solitary" means in the absence of people. "Exclusively" means with certainty. How so? They themselves speak and teach them. Or alternatively, the brahmins say this: "The Vedas are under no circumstances to be read by one who is not a brahmin." And the treatise on the constellation-science of the naked-ascetic renunciants is not given to those who are not naked-ascetic renunciants. And the treatises such as the Five Night-watches of the Vaiṣṇavas are not to be recited to others — so they say — but in solitary places, to those disciples who hold certainty in each respective teaching, these are to be recited.

Regarding "by you" and so forth: this is like the roar of a lion, and so it is a lion's roar. This is what it teaches: you, by uttering the lion's roar, teach all

renunciants, brahmins, practitioners, and wanderers without any jealousy and without any partiality.

Regarding "Sāṃkhya" and so forth: the reality according to Sāṃkhya is explained thus: "When a person, with courage of heart, enters into this nature possessing the forms of activity and inertia, and the yogi who sees the twenty-five realities becomes fully solitary — at that time liberation will come." So they say.

"Bhāradvāja" means that he is the son of the sage Bharadvāja, and so he is called Bhāradvāja. "Having seen that very thing" refers to seeing that reality as expounded by the Sāṃkhyas. This is the account as heard thereafter: that Bhāradvāja, devoted to the practice of fierce austerities and knowing reality through the Sāṃkhya knowledge, dwelt in a forest. The deities dwelling in that forest saw him, and they thought: "If he continues these austerities, he will become capable of obstructing us — so let us cause him to break these austerities." With that thought, a divine daughter named Vasantī — "Spring-Bearer" — was sent, wearing fine silks, to dance near his dwelling place, and she began to sing.

When the sage heard this, he emerged from his leaf-bower. The mere sight of that goddess so powerfully stirred his attachment that his mind was tormented and agitated. He took her and entered the leaf-bower, and for a very long time he experienced and indulged in sensual pleasures together with her. Thus the meaning is: Bhāradvāja came to be utterly attached to and entranced by that divine daughter named Vasantī.

"The Master" means the Teacher — the one who has become sovereign over all phenomena. "Even those disciples of yours" — the meaning is: if even they have no attachment to women, what need is there to speak of you yourself? And indeed, one who knows the true nature of conditioned things in saṃsāra will never become attached to the five qualities of sensual desire, which are always perishing and utterly unworthy of reliance.

Regarding the passage beginning "by the owl," and so forth: the particularities of the owl — such as its flesh being used as an ingredient — are explained by those who compose the specialized treatises of the Vaiśeṣika school.

"To one who is distinguished" means: one should give to brahmins and others who possess genuine qualities, but not to just anyone else. As it is said: "Giving to a non-brahmin is equal in merit; giving to an ordinary brahmin yields twice as much; giving to one who recites the Vedas yields a hundredfold

or a thousandfold; and the merit of giving to one who has gone to the far shore of the Vedas is limitless." Therefore, a giver who desires a distinguished fruit should give to a brahmin who has reached the far shore of the Vedic learning, and not to others who are not brahmins — and indeed, even among brahmins, not to one who has not brought all the Vedas to their final completion. This is what is said.

Regarding the passage beginning "You, O protector," and so forth: the meaning is that the Blessed One declared, "O protector, you who have become a refuge — you should give even to a dog." A question arises: since this dog is not a distinguished field, why did he say one should give to it? For this reason the next phrase is spoken: "with compassion." Great beings should engage in giving motivated by compassion and not out of attachment to abundant results. As the Elder Ratnaketu has said:

When one sees a lowly, destitute person filled with longing,
yet without affection, seeking some other vessel of virtues out of desire for reward —

such a one, though giving, is comparable to a beggar.

Therefore, enter willingly into giving to beggars with compassion.

Thus your entering into giving is performed with reverence motivated by great compassion toward those who beg.

Regarding the passage beginning "bodily," and so forth: "bodily austerity" means the burning torment of the afflictions. "The knot made by it" means bondage — that is, the afflictions. "Destroying it" means shattering and completely abandoning it. As for who it is that wishes to destroy the knot even of the body — "the naked ones" is the answer given, meaning the naked ascetics (nirgrantha) who are mendicants without clothing. Their philosophical conclusion is this: the karma performed in former lives is exhausted through austerity; and in this present life, one should not newly accumulate either virtue or non-virtue; therefore, when the karma residing in the bodily continuum is exhausted, rebirth is exhausted; when rebirth is exhausted, suffering is exhausted; and when suffering is exhausted, nirvāṇa is attained. Such is their contention.

Regarding the passage beginning "You," and so forth: because it is of the mind, it is called "of the mind," or alternatively, because this belongs to the mind, it is mental austerity. The meaning being taught is: you, by mental austerity alone, desire to destroy the knot, to exhaust karma, and to exhaust

the afflictions — and not by bodily means. In this vein, the master Aśvaghoṣa has said:

The self desires affliction and childish beings;
likewise it is attached to the various objects of the sense faculties.
Both of these I see to be bound up with fault.
My path of understanding the nectar is pure.

And so forth. Therefore the reasoning is this: since the mind is the dwelling-place of all afflictions without exception and therefore the very source of all harm, one must by all means purify it so that it does not subsequently become the ground for the afflictions. From a place without ground, afflictions will not arise; without afflictions, karmic actions will not come forth; and without those, no new rebirth will be taken.

Without that, there is liberation — this the Blessed One has well taught. Physical austerities are pointless, because the king of mind is in command, and therefore one should turn away from actions that are not to be done, rather than from the body itself.

As for "the logicians, for things," and so forth: "the logicians" refers to the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). "Things" refers to those who, though there is no self, no intrinsic nature, no time, no direction, and so forth, still hold that these nonexistent things truly exist and permanently abide, and take them as objects of their practice. "Without examination" means without having investigated or analyzed. For these tīrthikas spoke as follows:

By reasoning that is not in accord with Dharma,
one should not analyze at all.
If one becomes like a blind mute,
then examine what is being said.

Or again, one who cleaves supremely to treatises based on corrupt reasoning — that person is a logician. Such a one, having accepted texts with inverted names and with arguments that have many extremes as their basis, tries to establish as real even things that have no reality.

For example, they say: the cause of milk is curds; since milk arises from curds as its cause, milk resembles curds. Further, what arises from the cause of a cow — namely, curds — is the cause of milk; and so the curds that are the cause of milk arise from that same source, and therefore cow's curds are also a cause of milk. Whatever is not a cause of milk does not arise from that cause

— as, for example, a stone and the like. Here, even those who do not know may concede that cow's curds cannot themselves be the cause of milk, yet they are pleased to accept it just as it is. But one who possesses wisdom will understand it to be replete with many extremes — bloody discharge, hair, urine, and so forth.

Further, they hold that the self exists because its functions are directly observable, just as fire is. Their argument runs: whatever has its functions directly observable exists — just as fire is known to exist because the functions of ripening and so on are directly observable with respect to it; and wherever there is no fire, those functions are not observed — as, for example, a rabbit's horn. The self's functions too, they say, are being the agent, the enjoyer, the one who moves, the one who teaches, and so on. But those possessed of wisdom, recognizing that a body that could serve as its basis is not established, hold that the very cause for such a self is absent — and to this objection, they should reply that there are indeed many faults here.

As for "master of words," and so forth: "You, master of words" is an expression of address, meaning "you who are dominated by words" — that is, "one who is mighty in speech." The phrase "nothing whatsoever is well-spoken without examination" means: whatever is spoken without investigation and analysis, without being grounded in reasoning, is not well-spoken at all.

And the Blessed One's words, from "the suffering of birth, the suffering of old age," down through "in brief, the five aggregates subject to clinging are suffering" — all of this is exactly of that same character. Furthermore,

To have taken up moral discipline is happiness;
to give is to become joyful;
and loving-kindness is the antidote to aversion —

all of these and so forth are without inversion and are in every respect simply true — one should elaborate extensively in this vein.

As for "the lychee tree," and so forth: the lychee tree is the child of the pomegranate. Asked along what path, it says "having pierced the sun" — meaning, having bored through and entered the disc of the sun. Worldly people say that liberation is to pass through the middle of the solar disc. As for liberation: those who hold to the view of the buddhas consider liberation to be the absence of the aggregates — for the aggregates are suffering,

and the absence of those aggregates is liberation. And this is so in the following way: all five aggregates are attended by all three kinds of suffering, and so they remain in suffering against one's wishes. In them there is nothing whatsoever that is pleasant or desirable. Just as a heap of filth — because even a great heap of filth is itself filth, something that people find repugnant — so too, whether it is a middle-sized amount, a small amount, or even the most minute particle, it is equally repugnant, and gods and humans alike find the whole of it, in every respect, undesirable. This is stated because it is said: "The pure is what gods and humans praise." Thus, even the aggregates at the very summit of existence, since they are attended by formations at every single moment, are made unwanted; and if the noble ones hold even those to be suffering, what need is there even to mention what lies all the way down to the hells? Therefore, the absence of these aggregates, which have become suffering — that is the supreme bliss. And that is liberation.

Among the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), some explain it thus: by the power of gnosis, through the exhaustion of karma and afflictions, one no longer suffers through the person's body, faculties, and so forth, and liberation is the separation from all remaining obstacles and residues.

Others say: liberation is a distinctive state of dwelling accomplished through becoming thoroughly habituated to the distinctive quality of perpetual awareness, along with the complete abundance of all the pleasures and enjoyments of sensual bliss.

So then, what is liberation as understood here? The word "having understood" is used in the sense of coming to understand something not previously understood, so that afterward one has arrived at that liberation which is definitively known. This is connected with the phrase "the lychee tree obtains it by piercing through the sun."

And this is said to be as follows. A certain lychee tree, son of the great sage Vistarapuṣpa, looked upon beings tormented by a hundred afflictions and felt great weariness. Wishing to go to the city of fearless nirvāṇa, he received miraculous powers through the instructions of King Janaka, rose up into the sky, pierced through the center of the solar disc by the force of his miraculous powers, and entered the city of liberation — so it is said.

Furthermore, the verse reads: "You have passed into nirvāṇa, you have fully attained liberation, and yet you have gone nowhere at all." This refers to the Blessed One, who does not go anywhere. And as it is said: "Like a lamp that

has been extinguished, so his mind is fully released." Wherever the yogin practices, those very five aggregates of his pass into nirvāṇa and will not arise again.

Ācārya Aśvaghoṣa also said:

Just as when a lamp is extinguished
it goes neither below nor above
nor anywhere along the cardinal or intermediate directions —
it simply ceases through the exhaustion of its oil —
so too the Sage passed into nirvāṇa close at hand:
he went not to the earth, went not to light,
went not to any cardinal or intermediate direction —
he simply became peaceful through the exhaustion of afflictions.

As for the verse beginning "Liberation brings forth another transformation," and so forth: the one called King Janaka, abiding in great austerity, attained mastery of the path of yoga and, when his time came, departed from the body and passed into nirvāṇa. Then his student, the lychee tree, by his own body pierced through the center of the solar disc and went toward liberation by another path — so it is renowned.

As for the verse beginning "From what path did you yourself" and so forth: the meaning is that the student Śāriputra and the others attained liberation by going along that very same path by which you, the Blessed One Buddha, departed toward the path of liberation.

As for the verse beginning "Viṣṇu, with women" and so forth: Viṣṇu here is Nārāyaṇa. "Sixty thousand women" means that many women in number. "Taken hold of" means attended upon and made into servants. "Came to pass" means occurred. The story here was told in the context of the passage beginning "The old man was pierced by Viṣṇu's arrow."

"The Teacher" means one who shows and instructs — one who causes true showing to take place, that is the meaning. The meaning of "transcending the world" is that, having become the supreme among worlds, he transcends the world — that is, he has become the chief of the world. This is as the Blessed One himself declared: among all sentient beings, whether footless, two-footed, many-footed, form-possessing, or formless, the Tathāgata is the highest.

"Having no self of one's own" — that which has become devoid of any aspect of self is the absence of self. By this, through the abandonment of the view of

the transitory collection, the text teaches freedom from affliction itself.

"Without grasping" means that he possesses no clinging related to queens and the like, or clinging related to enjoyments and possessions — that is what "without grasping" means. By this, the text teaches the abandonment of the substance of affliction. And because there is no grasping at the substance of affliction, it is called by that name.

As for the verse beginning "To Kāśīsubhagā" and so forth: this is what was heard afterward. Not long after the battle of Bhārata had passed, a certain man of the Vṛṣṇi clan, his mind cast down by poverty and suffering, wandering about, went to the city of Vārāṇasī. In the middle of the street he saw, near a doorway, surrounded by a great crowd of people, the chief of the courtesans, one called Kāśīsubhagā. His mind drawn to watching her, he went up to her and asked: "Whose house is this?" And hearing of her qualities of form and the like, his mind was captivated.

Then a certain messenger said to Kāśīsubhagā: "A certain ascetic stands waiting at the door." Frightened by the possibility of a curse, she went forward herself to receive him, preceded by offerings of food and water for washing the feet and the like. She had him enter within, seated him on a cushion in a secluded place, and herself washed his feet. When the Vṛṣṇi man spoke with her, he recognized it as an opportunity and, overcome with joy, said: "Why do you smile without reason?" She replied: "You are said to be skilled in all the arts, yet you do not know how to massage hands and feet." He said: "If you become skilled in this, stretch out your hand and I will show you." And she gave him her hand.

Then, just as one of special quality among those who desire contact caused him to feel a sensation such as he had never before experienced with any of the many objects of desire — so too he became thoroughly attached and there arose in him the desire to enjoy her company for an exceedingly long time. To whom was he attached? To Kāśīsubhagā, the chief of the courtesans.

"Transformed" means that through experiencing desire for an exceedingly long time, he underwent transformation itself.

"Even while dwelling as a householder" means even without having gone forth into renunciation.

"Degraded" means not being noble, having become one who is blamed.

"The lords of the senses" means the five objects of the senses — the eye and so forth — that is, the five qualities of desire.

"Not bewildered" means not having undergone transformation.

Regarding the verse line "Vāsava, tormented by desire, distracted and dissolute" and so forth: "tormented by desire" means being burned and pierced by desire — the meaning being afflicted and oppressed by the attachment of desire. "Distracted and dissolute" means having become shameless through instability and a wavering mind.

Regarding the verse line "trampled by the woman's feet": the meaning is struck and trampled by that woman's two feet. Who was it? Vāsava. And this is how it came about: while the sage Vāsava was sitting together with Kāśīsubhagā, experiencing the bliss of pleasure and attachment, at a certain time the king of the city of Vārāṇasī, called Brahmadaṭṭa, faced the threat of attack from an enemy force, and since even young men were ordered to dig trenches ten arm-spans across in a single day, there was no need to mention anyone else. Kāśīsubhagā was likewise given this order, and even though she offered great wages in search of hired laborers, she could find none and fell to worrying. Vāsava said, "Why are you unhappy? Give me a pickaxe and a hoe, and I will dig the trench." So saying, he dug as much as was needed, but the trench was not yet finished when the sun drew near to setting. Then Vāsava thought the evening hour had come, and without having rested, he remained right there where he was. As the day was completed by such signs as the water-clock and the like, and knowing that the night-time had arrived, while the king and his ministers, together with the townsfolk, were distracted in mind and exerting themselves in going about their affairs, another brahmin, whose mind was wandering as he dug his own trench, caught sight of Vāsava and after some time recognized him. Then, having heard from him, the king and the ministers, together with the townspeople, went to his side, touched his two feet, and begged his pardon. But Vāsava turned his face away and simply continued digging. Growing frightened of the curse, and understanding that this was work belonging to Kāśīsubhagā's lot, they sent a messenger to her, saying, "Release this exceptional sage from digging the trench that has been allotted as your share." She sent a maidservant three times, but he had no wish to rise. Then Kāśīsubhagā herself mounted a conveyance and came, and having descended from it, she trampled his head with her foot, which bore an anklet, saying, "I was distressed, and I sent word three times — why will you not get up?" Vāsava's heart was gladdened, and he said, "Because she has

shown such great affection, she is very dear to me," and he rose.

"Even while dwelling as a householder" means that even though he was surrounded by a retinue of sixty thousand queens, he remained undisturbed and unagitated toward them — for if his mind was not even moved toward the queens, what need is there to say he could fall into such a state? This is teaching the impossibility of it.

Regarding the verse line "Karṇin, hard to fight, and so forth" and what follows: the story is as follows. There was a king named Kuntibhoja, and he had a daughter named Kuntī, who was endowed with beauty, youth, and every excellence. At a certain time a sage named Durāśaya entered that household and made porridge, and having prepared it quickly, he took up in his hands a vessel filled with the porridge, and —

and he caused her to partake of the food with reverence, her countenance and complexion unchanged, even though she was enduring great suffering in her hands. When the meal was finished, he saw that both her lotus hands were unburnt, and being fully pleased he said: "Ask a boon of me. If you are satisfied, I shall grant you such a boon that whoever you desire shall come under your own power." He then gave her a mantra incantation, saying, "If you recite this mantra up to five times, it will bring you the accomplishment of whatever you openly desire," and having said this, he departed.

She then sat down in her place and the thought arose in her: "Is the meaning of this mantra true, or is it not?" — and in order to test it, she recited it and offered a prayer to meet the sun. At that very instant the sun, complete with his chariot and clad in armor, appeared before her. When she saw him she tried to turn him away, saying, "Do not come to me." But the sun said: "Having been petitioned by you, I shall not depart without performing the act. Otherwise I shall lay a curse that destroys your entire lineage." She replied: "How can one destroy one's own lineage?" — and thereupon he granted her the gift of perpetual youth, and having sported with her in sensual pleasure, the sun departed.

Immediately thereafter, there was born to her a child equipped with a coat of armor and wearing two ears adorned with earrings — and this was Karṇin. Meanwhile, a female companion filled the boy's mouth with honey and butter, wrapped his body in very soft cloth, placed him in a box, and taking it went by night to the bank of the Gaṅgā, saying:

"This beautiful son of the sun —
let the ocean guard this box;
let the assembled hosts of the gods,
and Brahmā too, protect him always."

Having said this, she cast it into the Gaṅgā. Not far from the Gaṅgā, a charioteer of the region of Kuru, whose horse-drawn chariot excelled in surveillance, was tending horses. When he saw the box being carried along by the current of the Gaṅgā, he commanded his attendants to retrieve it and bring it, and upon seeing the child, he thought: "This shall be my son," and he raised him.

Now at that time, on the great mountain, there was one called Ānanda the Foe-Warrior, skilled in the techniques of weaponry and practicing austerities. He had made this vow: "I shall not teach these techniques of weaponry to any but brahmins." So Karṇin dressed himself in the manner of a brahmin and went to him, and learned the brahmin's techniques of weaponry — and the other taught him everything. Having learned the techniques of weaponry thoroughly, he went forward to the tournament of battle, and having vied for the sponsorship of being his own patron, he was given the land of Aṅga and became the king of Aṅga. The story continues at length in this way.

At a certain point, Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) thought: "Now the time of battle draws near; Karṇin will come into conflict with Sred-sgrub." So Śakra dressed himself as a brahmin and went before Karṇin. Three times he was asked, "Why have you come?" and though invited as a guest he was unwilling to speak plainly. When at last he was asked seven times, "What do you want?" — he replied that he wanted Karṇin's armor. Karṇin said: "Why did you not speak before? I shall give it to you without hesitation," — and with those words he took a vajra knife, peeled the armor from his body, and gave it to him. Śakra, fully pleased, then said:

"There is no giver like Karṇin
who, for the sake of satisfying a suppliant,
does not spare even his own life —"

"— nor is there any loving friend to equal me."

So it was spoken. The tales of these figures are very numerous, but they have not been told here at length.

Now, upon hearing the tale of Duryodhana, these four — Aṅgaśobhana, Nānāvīrya, Bhayaṃkara, and Vipula — were brothers, born of the Gaṅgā. Aṅgaśobhana, king of the gandharvas (celestial musicians), was killed on the field of battle by the grudge of a namesake. Nānāvīrya died struck by a great plague. Bhayaṃkara had entered into the celibate life, and his mother, Sukhavat, said to him: "Our family line is about to be cut off — make the effort to produce a son." He replied: "We are brothers, it is true, but I have been celibate from youth and will not experience the pleasure of sensual enjoyment." When he refused, all the kinsmen of that lineage assembled and made supplication to Vipula. From Ambikā, Ambālikā, and a certain wise woman — those three — and from the assembly of Vipula, in due succession, three were born: Viśvakṣetra, Śyāmāśramaṇa, and Buddhimant. Of these, Viśvakṣetra became blind, and Śyāmāśramaṇa conquered the entire great earth and gave it to Viśvakṣetra. Vipula granted a boon to Viśvakṣetra, saying: "From your noble gandharva wife, may a hundred sons be born, and from among them an elder brother shall arise who is called Duryodhana."

In time, the gandharva wife became pregnant, and after three years a lump of flesh resembling an iron hammer was born. Vipula then said: "Divide this lump of flesh into a hundred portions, set each apart separately, and sprinkle cool water upon them again and again." Then in time, from those portions there came forth a hundred sons endowed with all their faculties complete. Buddhimant said to Viśvakṣetra: "Because Duryodhana is possessed of the characteristics of wickedness, know that through him all the lineages of evil repute will be destroyed. He must be killed by every means. In killing one son and thereby saving the lives of many living beings, we see no fault whatever. For it is said in the treatises on Dharma:

A great evil whose fruit is slight —
do that never.

A small evil of great purpose —
the wise should always undertake.

Having spoken thus, he was unable to kill the child out of love for his son. Śyāmāśramaṇa went to the forest to practice austerities. Buddhimant was one possessed of the word of Dharma, and when Viśvakṣetra became powerless, Duryodhana became king. Then, at great length, the story continues from Karṇa up to Duryodhana's breaking of the battle line. At that time, when Siddhārtha had made supplication, Viṣṇu became the charioteer and drove him out onto the battlefield. While stationed there, Siddhārtha looked out upon

all the assembled armies and spoke thus:

Seeing them as his own kin,
the son of Kunti surveyed them all —
each arrayed there as a beloved relative.
Overwhelmed by supreme love,
he was downcast and said:

"Seeing his kinsmen, O Viṣṇu,
standing there in readiness for battle,
my body has grown faint,
my mouth utterly dries.
My body trembles
and my hair stands on end.
The bow falls from my hand
and my skin burns all over.
My mind reels
and I am unable to remain steady.
The very ones for whose sake
I desired kingship, wealth, and happiness —
those same ones have abandoned their lives and riches
and stand here to fight me."

So he spoke, and he would not fight. When Viṣṇu saw that he was without spirit, he spoke to inspire courage in him, so that the wicked might be slain:

"Born of the water-jar, Bhayaṃkara — victor — chariot-warrior — Karna, and —"

"Just so, I have slain other heroes of the world. You — do not be troubled in your mind; slay them. In battle you shall become the undisputed victor. Moreover, know that by which all this is conquered to be imperishable and indestructible. It cannot be slain by anyone. This body will come to an end, but the embodied ones are declared to be eternal. Since it perishes and becomes measureless, fight, O Bharata! Just as a man casts off old garments and takes on new ones, so too does he cast off the old body and take on new bodies." And so saying, Viṣṇu spoke other such words. Following those words of his, Siddhasādhaka opened the battle and slew countless hundreds of thousands of living creatures.

Now regarding the phrase "for the sake of sentient beings" and what follows: the word "sentient beings" means living creatures. "Wishing to benefit them"

means wishing to bring about their very benefit. Having wished it, what did he do? "You even gave up your life" — and here the birth-tale of the Lotus-Bearer and others should be applied as examples.

Now regarding "Viṣṇu, having made illusion" and what follows: illusion here is the form of deception. Having made that illusion, what did he do? The words "three strides" and so forth are spoken. This is to be understood as follows: Viṣṇu transformed himself into the form of a dwarf, and with three strides he seized the domain from Indra the Mighty, and that land was later abandoned and given away many times over, like so much grass. What was the manner of your own? The phrase "wishing for liberation" is spoken, meaning: he who wishes to attain definitive liberation — that is one who wishes for liberation. Here the sūtra of the Great Vision of Joy and others should be applied as examples. The account of Viṣṇu's illusion was already spoken earlier, in the section beginning "Viṣṇu, having transformed himself into the form of a dwarf."

Now regarding "the arrow that brings joy and cuts life" and what follows: hear how it went. The sage Jāmadagni had a wife who was a disciplined ascetic woman. His son was named Joymaker, an exceedingly valiant young man. At that time there arose a king named Siddhasādhaka, who went to the place where a herd of cattle was grazing. There he encountered a sage named Mānava, a man who delighted in combat. At the sound of hailstones, one of Jāmadagni's wishfulfilling cows was frightened. When King Siddhasādhaka asked about this, Mānava said: "This cow was frightened by the snapping of the bowstring of Jāmadagni's son, who was practicing archery." Thereupon Joymaker, born of the Jāmadagni lineage, overcame his adversary, spoke in praise of his own qualities, and Mānava, enraged, conceived the arrogance of wishing to fight Joymaker at all costs. He went to the settlement, stole a calf, and threw a dead snake onto the body of Joymaker while Joymaker was abiding in meditative concentration. Now Dusty One had a good and gracious nature, and when she walked down with flowers the trees would bow down of their own accord. When she saw the king she became attracted to him, and from that time onward the trees no longer bowed down. Jāmadagni perceived this through the power of his meditative concentration, and angered at his wife, he commanded Joymaker: "Cut off your mother's head!" And Joymaker, the moment the command was uttered, cut off her head.

Then the father, being pleased, said: "Dear son, ask a boon."

He asked as his boon that his mother be restored to life, and she was indeed restored to life. From that time on, enraged at that cause, Joymaker swore an oath: "I will make it so that not a single member of the warrior nobility (kṣatriya) remains in the world." Thereafter he took up his weapons, went forth equipped for war, joined battle with those who were establishing royal rule, and every arm those warriors had — of which he had a thousand — he cut off and laid them flat upon the ground. Then, having made his start, he plunged into the task of annihilating the warrior nobility by the roots and wiped them from the world entirely. And thus it is said: having made the warrior nobility of the world nonexistent.

As for who did this: the text mentions "the arrow of the life-taker." What eliminates living creatures, making them spent and gone, is the taking of life; and because the arrow is the instrument of that, it is called the arrow of the life-taker — that is what did it.

"Who has obtained fame" means: one who has obtained renown and gain. "Joymaker" refers to Joymaker with his axe. "That" refers to the deed of Joymaker. "Toward your teaching" means toward the teaching of the Blessed One, the Buddha. "Not fame" means that it has become infamous. And this is how it is: in your teaching, even killing a living creature as small as an ant is a ground for reproach — how much more so the slaying of the warrior nobility; there is no need even to speak of that.

Regarding the phrase "harsh sounds and loud battle cries" and so on: "harsh sounds" refers to the cries of hard-fought combat and the like; "loud battle cries" refers to steadfastness on the field of battle and so on. "For whose sake the battle is waged" means: one fights and wages war for the sake of the splendor of royal sovereignty. And because they engaged in battle in order to secure the splendor of royal sovereignty, the living creatures comprising the eighteen divisions of the armed forces were brought under the power of death. "That splendor" refers to the excellent and complete splendor of royal sovereignty upon the earth — and that he abandoned and utterly cast aside.

As for how he abandoned it: the text says "like a tree wound round by a venomous snake." Just as someone, out of fear, abandons a tree around which a venomous snake has coiled itself, so too, wounded by the venom of the snake of wrongdoing — the Blessed One — a sovereignty full of suffering that in a mere instant had turned joyful was utterly abandoned, and he went forth without hesitation.

Regarding the phrase "finding your teaching" and so on: "your teaching" means the teaching of you who are the protector, namely the sacred scriptural collection known as the speech that tames through Dharma. "Finding it" means knowing it through careful investigation. "In the sāl-tree forest" refers to a forest of sāl trees. The great god dwelling there — that means the Blissful One. "Yoga" is a particular excellence of meditative concentration; because one has mastery over it, one is called a lord of yoga — meaning the sages who have attained the various meditative concentrations. The conduct of a lord of yoga consists in bodily transformations. "What" means: what is taught. "That" means: what is described. "Not knowing" means utter confusion; and because his conduct was a mode of delusive transformation, it is called conduct in ignorance.

This too is what is shown: if one hears of what the great god did to the sages who are lords of yoga dwelling in the sāl-tree forest, and then looks at the scriptural collection of your teaching, one will understand that it is a deluded aberration born of profound ignorance.

The account pertaining to this was written in the section on the Great God's (Śiva's) epithet "Possessor of Desire," and so it will not be written again here.

Now, regarding the passage beginning "Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), the ratless Gautamī," and so forth: "Śakra" refers to the Hundred-Powered One. "The ratless one" refers to the wife of the brahmin Gautama. "The brahmins still proclaim her" means that brahmins continue to slander her even now. Why? Because she is called "rat," that is, one who behaves improperly. This is so because, in the Vedas, she is invoked in the context of calling upon Śakra, being recited as "the ratless, the rat."

Regarding the passage beginning "your," and so forth: the fame of your qualities is proclaimed and made known by Śakra himself. What does he proclaim? The phrase "attained the supreme fruit" — and here the word "supreme fruit" is taken to mean the fruit of stream-entry, since it is so named in relation to all worldly fruits. This fruit is attained by means of the undefiled path and is irreversible. Moreover, this fruit, or the phrase beginning "the certain forerunner," and so forth, as explained in the Abhidharma, is to be compared with the sūtra in which Śakra makes his inquiry here.

Regarding the passage beginning "Viṣṇu did so with dark-mottled," and so forth: in this world there arose two beings — one known as the dark-mottled asura (demigod), and the other called Sarvatyāgin, possessing great power

over enemies. Through mutual arrogance they came into conflict, each striving to conquer the three worlds. Viṣṇu, unable to endure that one's striving, applied himself to the means of killing him. At a certain time Viṣṇu took up his discus, went to the dark-mottled one's presence and engaged him in combat. Then, struck by that one's club, his body was bruised, and Viṣṇu trembled, was cowed, and began to flee. Finding no other refuge, he crept beneath the bed on which Sarvatyāgin was sleeping.

That one then came quickly, saying, "Where have you gone? Come out again!" At this, Sarvatyāgin awoke. Having awoken, he saw him come, and heard a pitiful cry from beneath the bed saying, "Save me!" He thought: "This one has surely come to kill me, and my attendant, out of fear, has crept beneath this bed." Thinking thus, he said: "Who can endure such utter contempt as this?" He took up a weapon, rose to his feet, and the two fell to fighting one another, and both were killed.

Now, Viṣṇu is the son of Brahma. The dark-mottled one is the asura; "dark-mottled" designates the one marked by fear and terror. "Thereby thrown into confusion" means his mind was thrown into turmoil. "He crept beneath the bed of Sarvatyāgin" means he crept there out of fear, beneath the bed of the asura Sarvatyāgin.

"O lord, you" is a mode of address meaning "O Sovereign One" — that is, the sense of "Īśvara." "Without fear" means one who is without dread and terror, who is not afraid. Of what is he not afraid? The word "entirely" is used — meaning the Tathāgata is declared to be one who has gone entirely beyond all fear.

Regarding the passage beginning "The lord of creatures, by himself," and so forth: upon hearing this, in this middle aeon there was a lord of creatures named Swift. At a certain time there was born a girl called Excellent Conduct who, by her qualities of beauty and so forth, overshadowed all the other divine maidens.

Because of this, the lord of creatures named Swift was struck with wonder of mind at the fact that she overshadowed the entire world, and thought: "I myself am incapable of producing and bringing forth one such as this." He then took her and went all the way to the world of Brahma, and introduced her there. As soon as Brahma, the Great God (Śiva), and Dharma — who also dwells in bodily form — had all assembled in one place, he said, "Look at this one, my daughter Excellent Conduct, who outshines them all," and remained

right there. As soon as Brahma was overcome by desire and became unable to restrain his own mind, he lay with her in transgression. In exactly the same way, the Great God, Dharma, and the lord of creatures Swift also entered into transgression with her. Immediately thereafter, four sons with distinguishing colors were born at the same time. Brahma then declared, "They are all my sons." The Great God and the others said likewise, and as a result of this, a clamor arose from the world of Brahma and spread throughout the world. Upon hearing this dispute, the gods headed by Śakra (Indra) came and, in order to settle the quarrel, declared:

A child in this world will generally
resemble its father;
whoever resembles whom in physical form —
that one belongs to that one.

After that, each one took as his own the son who matched him in physical form. Now in the text, "the lord of creatures" means Swift; "by himself" means of his own accord; "daughter" means his own daughter; "lay with" means he engaged in sensual activity — that he experienced the pleasure of desire together with her; "heard" means he heard the news as it was; "O Sage, you" is a form of address; and "disciples as well" means the śrāvakas too — as for the Blessed One, the buddha, it goes without saying, and this is to be understood from the particle "as well."

Regarding the line "Celibacy (brahmacarya) is without fault": celibacy here means restraint of the sense faculties and the restraint of ethical conduct. "Without fault" means that whatever celibacy is free from the stain of defilement, that is without fault.

Regarding the passage beginning "The brahmins," and so forth: "giving and receiving" means to give to others and to receive from others, and because the two abide on equal terms, it is called "continually giving and receiving." What do they transfer? The text says "virtue and non-virtue." Virtue is merit — that is, acting well. Non-virtue is what is not merit — that is, acting wrongly. The transfer of that virtue and non-virtue is the transference. Who says this? The text says "the brahmins," meaning the seers (ṛṣis). And indeed it is like this: just as it is fitting to give gold, grain, food, drink, and so forth to others, and to receive them from others, so too merit and non-virtue are comparable — that is the brahmins' assertion: the non-virtues such as killing a brahmin and so forth can be received for payment from others in a transfer, and merit

is likewise the same. This is their philosophical conclusion.

Regarding the passage beginning "By you," and so forth: if that were so, performed actions would be wasted — for having engaged in wholesome and unwholesome conduct, the ripening of those deeds would be wasted without maturing for the one who performed them, since the ripening has been passed on to others. And one would encounter the results of what one had not done, since one would experience the pleasant and unpleasant fruits of what was done by another. Therefore those positions are unreasonable, for if what is done by one person were to be experienced by another person —

why would a son be satiated merely by the father eating food? If understanding arising in one person were to arise in another, then why would hearing a treatise once not result in grasping and knowing all treatises whatsoever? And if such transference were possible, why would it be understanding itself that gets transferred? As it is said:

One teaches others, yet does no virtue oneself —
the deeds done by another, one does not follow after.
Through what one has acquired oneself, actions are not wasted;
nor is there any fruit established for what was not done.
What was not done is never something that was done;
apart from what was not done, there is no ease.
There is no going to that prosperity —
therefore strive in the deeds of virtue.

Regarding the passage beginning "The defining characteristic of the Kapila," and so forth: the expression "defining characteristic of the self" means the defining characteristic of the person. The phrase "endowed with cognition" means endowed with understanding — the inquiry into the essential nature of consciousness is the understanding of consciousness as constituting the own-nature of the person. Moreover, in the beginning of the eon there arose a sage known as Kapila, and he was the one who composed the Sāṃkhya treatise. His students, too, were called Kāpilas — sons of Kapila — and so the students as well are called "sons," and what the Kāpilas investigated is what they accepted as a thesis. This is shown to be a mere imputation lacking rational justification.

Regarding the passage beginning "By you," and so forth: if that thesis is accepted, then it follows, as you, the Protector, have shown, that the self would be impermanent, unstable, and subject to momentary destruction. This

too is unreasonable, for they accept the person as being endowed with mind and as being permanent. The reason is as follows: first, through the sense faculty of the eye, form is cognized, and at that same time the person cognizes sound and the rest. Now if the self were something that has the form of consciousness and were permanent, it would always be cognizing only form as its object, and thereby with regard to sound and the rest it would be like one who is deaf and dumb. Yet no such case appears in the world. Alternatively, if form were to be cognized through other sense faculties, and sound and the rest were to be cognized through still others on another occasion, then this would result in the self being distinctly multiple — and the fault of transformation and so forth would follow.

Here an objection is raised in verse:

How can what is permanent, possessed of all objects,
be called "a person"?

If it depends on other causes,
how then can it be permanent?

Whatever has understood something,
that is not a self possessed of permanence.

If the self, like a pot, were impermanent,
it would become like a rabbit's horn.

Whatever capacity there is to accomplish a purpose —
that purpose exists for an ultimate aim.

Were it to become non-existent and momentary,
it would be contradicted whether by gradual or instantaneous sequence.

Such is the argument and so forth.

The "great sage Ulūka" — the word "consciousness" here means that whose nature is understanding; it is one's own quality in the service of others' aims. Therefore the self is other than that — it is not posited as having the form of the person-who-is-consciousness in the manner that the Sāṃkhya impute. "All-pervading" means pervading everything. "To be thoroughly declared" means: it is thoroughly declared that this self is other than and pervading consciousnesses — that is the meaning.

Now this great sage Ulūka, the author of the Vaiśeṣika treatise, thinks as follows: if the self were of the nature of understanding, it would follow that it is impermanent, and the self must be accepted as permanent. Therefore the self is not something that has the form of consciousness; rather, consciousness is

that whose nature is understanding. And that consciousness, having functioned with respect to an object, dwells close to the person by means of the reflection of the object,

and because it is both all-pervasive and permanent, there is no fault here whatsoever — so they say.

Regarding the passage beginning "Your position," and so forth: if that is so, then because that self has no understanding it would follow that it is like a piece of wood — this is the meaning of the statement. For if the self has not even the slightest understanding, then grass and trees and the like likewise have not even the slightest understanding, and in that case there would be no distinguishing difference whatsoever between grass, trees, and the like on the one hand and this self on the other.

Here an objection is raised in verse:

If the self is without understanding,
one need not accept that it is like wood and grass.
From the mere equivalence of being without understanding,
how does it follow that the other lacks mind?
If the self's reality is permanent,
what sort of permanence is that?
How could it be reasonable that acting and engaging
remain permanent?
Faults such as these would accrue
to this system — so it follows.
Therefore the learned do not accept
this position either as valid.

Regarding the passage beginning "Just as a naked ascetic has the measure of a body," and so forth: the word "naked" refers to the Naked Ones, those of the Digambara party. "Just as the measure of a body" means that because it is the measure of a body, that is, of form, it is comparable to the measure of a body — it is possessed of that measure. And this measure is extremely subtle in something extremely subtle, and large in something large. It is called the life-principle, and it pervades the entire body; the body then abides like a basket for it. Hence, when the body contracts, that contracts; when the body expands, that expands. And contraction means drawing together — that which has it, together with its attendant qualities, is the stretching-out; and this is called the life-principle, the living one, and the self — so they say.

Life-principle, birth, sustenance, person, and individual are synonymous enumerations. "Says" means that this teacher of the Naked Ones speaks thus. This is what the twenty-five teachers of the Naked Ones — Ṛṣabha, Vṛddhi (Growth), and the rest — teach and say.

Regarding the passage beginning "You," and so forth: "You" means that you have taught that this life-principle and living entity are destructible and impermanent. Why is that? Because it has a single aspect — that is stated. Something that has one aspect is one-sided, meaning it has parts. Something that has no aspect whatsoever is not suitable to be a substantial entity. Whatever has parts and aspects — all such things are impermanent. Now since body and life-principle are accepted to be one-sided, this life-principle too is impermanent in the manner of something that has parts, and the body, sharing one aspect with it, is likewise impermanent. To be both permanent and possessed of parts is unreasonable and contradicts valid cognition.

A summarizing verse on this point:

If something has one aspect, how can it be permanent?

If it is permanent, it does not have one aspect.

The two modes of substantial connection are absent.

Therefore this system is not reasonable.

Regarding the passage beginning "The cause of beings for the Brahmins," and so forth: "Brahmins" here means learned scholars of treatises such as the Mīmāṃsakas and others of the investigative tradition — that is the meaning. They hold that the cause is the person. The cause of what? It is stated: "the cause of beings" — that is to say, of the entire world without exception. Furthermore, the established conclusion is this: the person present in the lineage of Devadatta is the cause of Devadatta himself, but not of sacrificial acts and the like. "Cause" means "the cause that is the one who brings about" — that is the meaning. What kind of cause? It is stated: "a permanent person." "Person" and "self" are not different in meaning. "Permanent" means unchanging. For although a seed and the like can also serve as a cause, they are not permanent; therefore this distinguishing qualifier sets it apart. "Asserted" means held with firm conviction.

Regarding the passage beginning "By you" and so forth: if something is permanent, it cannot be a cause; and if it is a cause, it cannot be permanent — "permanent" and "cause" are terms that are mutually exclusive. The proper argument here is as follows: whatever serves as a cause is impermanent, just

as seeds and the like are impermanent. Therefore, the person who is held to be the cause of those things should be understood to be impermanent as well. Furthermore, there simply is no such thing as a permanent cause — just as space and the like are permanent, they are not causes. If what is permanent were itself a cause and were to become permanent in that way, that would flatly contradict valid cognition. Something that is both unchanging and permanent while also functioning as a cause — such a thing does not exist even in the slightest. This is the meaning of what you yourself have said: there is absolutely nothing of the kind.

Here the objection is stated in verse:

If it is permanent, whose cause can it be?
If it does not perish, how can it be a cause?
"Permanent" and "being a cause" —
it is not reasonable to treat these two as one.
Whatever is held to be permanent as a cause —
that thing, in just that way, is not permanent;
for since it has an action to perform,
it will never be found in every respect.
If it were to perform an action,
or if it did not perform it —
even so, it would follow with certainty
that it is impermanent.

Now, regarding the passage beginning "The great being who is poisonous," and so forth: the story connected with this is as follows. There were two brothers, asuras (demigods) named Windfall and Earthly. Windfall was made to take the form of a thick, dense creature, and Earthly was made to take the form of a human. In this guise they invited the sages as guests. Windfall hid himself, and with great hospitality they were served food. After the sages had eaten, Earthly went outside and called out, "My son Windfall, wherever you are, come here!" — and the very moment he called, whatever each of those who had eaten possessed in their bellies was split open and spilled out. By this act, all but a small remnant of the communities of sages and brahmins were destroyed. The sacrificial offerings made to the gods were also exhausted.

Then the gods assembled and went to the hermitage of the great sage Agata to petition him to slay those two asuras. Now, when the two brothers had invited Agata as their guest and he had eaten there, and when Earthly called

out asking where his son Windfall had gone, the sage discharged a curse and said, "I have already made my petition" — and then, inflamed with anger, he consumed Earthly right there in plain sight. Meanwhile, Windfall, tormented by the power of an intense thirst, drank from whatever lakes, ponds, and pools he found, and yet could not be satisfied. He went on and came to drink from the ocean.

At that time there was a king named Poisonous. He had two wives: by one he had a son named Unrestrained, and by the other he had sixty thousand sons, born through the blessing of the Great God (Śiva). Now, the king was about to perform the horse sacrifice and had taken the vow for it. He had appointed the horses, tied to the sacrificial post as offerings, fitted with sacrificial implements, provided with fire-hearths and the rest, and to guard those horses, all sixty thousand of his sons were equipped with armor and stood guard armed with various weapons.

At this point Viṣṇu thought: "If this entire ocean were to dry up, what means could be used to refill it?" He then thought: "Since I need this ocean refilled, and since the horses are here at the site of King Poisonous's horse sacrifice, if I steal the horses, I can accomplish my purpose from this." With that thought he went and took the horses and disappeared underground.

When Poisonous's sons heard of this, the ocean dried up and sank underground. Viṣṇu, assuming the appearance and dress of a yellow-robed sage —

Viṣṇu was seen sitting upon a lion throne with all the horses gathered there. Poisonous's sons thought, "He is the one who stole them," and their fury became unbearable. With utter contempt they began to wrest the horses from Viṣṇu. When he understood that Poisonous's sons held him in contempt, he gazed upon them with eyes burning in anger, and reduced them all to ash. They died and were reborn in hell.

When Poisonous heard what had happened, he sent an envoy to retrieve the horses. The envoy went and, with praises to Viṣṇu and other offerings, won his favor, then took the horses and returned to his own city. From that point on the king performed the rites of the horse sacrifice without any interruption. When that king died, he was reborn in the realm of the gods. The envoy then became king, and he consecrated his son, named Swift, to rule the kingdom.

Swift then heard how his uncles had been reborn in hell on account of a certain cause. He thought: "King Poisonous has done nothing in their behalf, nor has

my father the envoy. I myself must accomplish what is needed for them." And so, in order to bring down the Gaṅgā, he practiced austerities for thirty thousand years of divine time, yet he was unable to bring the Gaṅgā down. When he passed away, his son Lipa practiced austerities for thirty thousand divine years in order to bring down the Gaṅgā, yet he too was unable. He likewise passed to another world.

His son Bhagoratha then pleased Brahmā through great austerities, and Brahmā granted him a supreme boon. Bhagoratha declared: "Let me accomplish this — let me bring the Gaṅgā down into the human world." Brahmā then commanded the Gaṅgā: "Flow down into the land of humans." At this the Gaṅgā gave a deep lament: "If I go there and become a common stream, even those of low caste and the like will make use of me. How shall I conduct myself in such a situation? It is surely not right to transgress the command of one's ancestor. Yet I shall flow with great force and plunge underground." But Brahmā rebuked her: "What are you doing — flowing underground without first purifying the human world?" And the Great God, Śiva, placed her within the mass of his matted locks.

From that moment she arose within them, and though flowing for a thousand divine years she could not find the end of those locks. Then Bhagoratha, through supremely exceptional austerities, pleased the Great God, who squeezed his locks, and a single drop fell upon the peak of the Himālayas. In an instant it became one great lake, which to this day has given rise to seven streams. It is said:

Sītā, Sindhu, Vakṣu,
and the Gaṅgā, ornament of the world —
Hrī, Tsim, and Nalinī:
these are taught as the seven.

The Gaṅgā then thought: "I shall cross over to the great southern ocean," and with haughty pride she bored through the Himālayas, so that through that channel she flowed easily down.

Now at that time there was a fierce ascetic named the sage Jahnu, who dwelt in a channel of the Himālayas striving in the practice of yoga. When he saw the Gaṅgā flowing noisily and coquettishly at an unhurried pace, he was greatly enraged. He went and declared:

"Here, close beside my dwelling place,
why does this woman walk without shame,

moving in her coquettish way?

This is great wickedness and evil conduct."

With that he took her up and drank her. Then Bhagoratha pleased that sage through austerities, and the sage vomited her forth. She then flowed unobstructed in all four directions, filled the underground passages, and washed away all the remaining traces of the condition in which Poisonous's sons had been bound. It is said that this also caused them to pass from hell and be reborn in the higher realms.

Thus it is stated that the sixty thousand sons of Poisonous were burned. "The Great Self" is so called because greatness of selfhood exists within it, and it is endowed with qualities such as exceedingly great enjoyment and so forth. Who is this? It is Poisonous — that is, the king called Ocean is known as Poisonous. Who are referred to? "His sixty thousand sons" — that is, his sixty thousand children. By whom? By one called the Yellow Brahmin — meaning by Viṣṇu dwelling in the form of a yellow brahmin. How? "By a mere glance" — this indicates it was by two eyes blazing with fury. What was done? "Burned" — that is, reduced to ash. "To these also" refers to the sixty thousand sons of Ocean. Alternatively, "to that" refers to what caused them to be severed from life. "You showed compassion" means that compassion arose in you toward them and you rendered them what they needed. Moreover, the Tathāgata never departs from the stream of great compassion itself. As someone who composed a hymn of praise has said:

Dwelling in the mind of compassion, ever-peaceful,
peace rests in your eyes.

Not for even the span of a moment of patience
are you able to be parted from it.

Because of supreme beauty, your mind was long enraptured —
yet you are renowned and celebrated as though free from desire.

As for the words "by that very Yellow Brahmin himself" and what follows — the sage born yellow explains that all beings, without exception, are born liberated from the principal. This is to be heard as follows. In the time of the first aeon, when the lifespan of living beings was without measure, there appeared a brahmin called the Yellow One. Dwelling in a hermitage, he attained liberation alone through the excellence of his austerities, and for the sake of showing others the path well, he composed treatises. He taught in them two

fundamental subject matters: namely, the principal and the person. The principal has three qualities — it is the doer, acting through the qualities of vitality, activity, and darkness; it undergoes transformation; and it is without mind. The person, on the other hand, is conscious, is the experiencer, is permanent, and is neutral. How is the principal said to be the doer? When the three qualities of vitality, activity, and darkness are in a state of equilibrium, along with their branches, that is the condition of the principal with its subsidiaries. Further, when any one of the three is somewhat stirred and not yet manifest, that is called the great one. From that there arises something slightly thicker, which is pride, and from that precise transformation comes the transformation into eleven faculties. These are the five cognitive faculties — the faculties of eye, ear, nose, tongue, and body — and the five active faculties — hand, foot, speech, the organ of elimination, and the organ of procreation — together with mind. From those five subtle essences arise the five great elements. From the subtle essence of sound comes space. From sound combined with touch comes wind. From those first two combined with form comes fire. From those first three combined with taste comes water. From those first four combined with smell comes earth. Counted in this way, the realities come to twenty-four. The person is the twenty-fifth. When one does not know the distinction between "this is a quality" and "this is the person," then the person and the qualities become commingled,

It is like a man filled with desire dwelling in a darkened room together with a beautiful woman who delights in him. But when he comes to know the distinction between the qualities and the person — knowing the person to be something separate from those qualities, something that merely undergoes transformation — then he will never again become intimate with her. This is just like a man with sight in the daytime not reaching out to touch a beautiful woman. Seeing the qualities and the person as distinct is the cause for attaining liberation: this is the established conclusion of the Sāṃkhyas.

What kind of wandering ascetic speaks in this way? It is said: "One who knows the real." The word "real" here refers to the twenty-five realities. Because one knows them, one is said to "know the real," and "knowing the real" means what is called "being learned."

Regarding the line "Your birth among wandering beings" and what follows: "affliction and karma" means affliction together with karma, and what is born and arises from them is called by that name, because birth proceeds from engagement with affliction. On this point the elder Aśvaghoṣa spoke in verse:

When affliction is exhausted there is no bondage to existence.

When karma is spent there is no suffering to be found.

Whatever arises from what exists as its source —
that will not arise again from what no longer exists.

As for the question of what it is that is born from affliction and karma, the text says "of wandering beings." Because they are subject to death they are called "wandering beings" — the world of sentient beings. Their birth arising from affliction and karma is what you have proclaimed and declared.

At this point it was said in verse:

Beings without affliction have no desire
to take birth anywhere whatsoever.
Without any karma at all,
pleasure and pain do not arise.

An arhat does not have affliction,
and without that, karma too does not exist;
from that there is no birth in this —
just like sprouts without a seed.

And so on, as has been said.

Regarding the line "The self of wandering ascetics (tīrthikas) and others is liberated" and what follows: it is claimed that the self — whatever constitutes the essence of wandering ascetics and the like — abides in liberation while also remaining the cause of continued existence. Furthermore, the person persists as permanent, and whatever body and sense faculties were previously compounded will again appear later. This is expressed in verses such as:

The person, being permanent,
endowed with body and sense faculties,
will appear again in the same form —
of this there is no doubt; it arises from conditions.

Regarding the line "You" and what follows: "having gone to peace" means having attained the realm in which no remainder of aggregates whatsoever persists. "Like a lamp gone out" means like a flame that has been extinguished. "Uncountable" means beyond enumeration.

Regarding "Some tīrthikas" and what follows: a "ford" is the path to liberation and the higher realms. The treatise that teaches this is called a "ford-maker"

because it constructs that ford. It is therefore accompanied by passage to liberation, that is, to nirvāṇa. "Passage" means going, and the one in whom this passage exists is one who possesses that going — meaning one who has attained it through going. The word "declares" indicates that this is a statement. To "declare" means to proclaim, as was said earlier in the passage: "It is said that Naitṛka, having surpassed the sun, declared that liberation exists." As for the line "That to which there is passage — that is saṃsāra."

"That to which there is passage — that is saṃsāra": the place to which there is going is saṃsāra, which is cyclic existence. And since there is going to it, the realization of nirvāṇa is not achieved. The Blessed One also declared in a sūtra: "Rohita, that place where there is no birth, no death, and no arising — that, I say, is not attained by going," and so forth.

"Having realized it, you declared it" — this means that the Blessed One, having known and realized it, thereupon taught and explained it.

Regarding "the naked ones, the pleasure gardens, and so forth": "the naked ones" refers to naked ascetics. Because everything there brings delight, it is a pleasure garden; whatever constitutes pleasure gardens and the like — that is what is meant by "pleasure gardens and so forth," including bathing pools and the like. "Construct" means to accomplish through effort. "The cause of evil" means the cause of engaging in wrongful conduct. This is because they uphold evil without cause and, relying on speculation, they propound it. As for this, there are many such statements:

One who dwells in pleasure gardens,
should be turned back from taking life.
If a living being there should die,
the one who acts, incurs the act.
When a conscious being dies,
that becomes a very great evil.
Therefore those who would accumulate merit
ought not to act in such a way.

And much more is said along these lines.

Regarding "the omniscient one, and so forth": "the omniscient one" is an invocation. "That very thing" refers to constructing the pleasure gardens and so forth. "The cause of merit" means accumulating merit in the near term. If one engages in an action that ought not to be engaged in, then from that action a very great wrongdoing will result.

When you slay living beings who wander,
sin will also accrue to you.
But if you yourself become without wandering,
then there is no slaying of living beings.
If it exists, then being possessed of sin,
how could one come to be liberated?
How could liberation coexist with that?
Is one liberated from accumulated sin?
Rather, those who have abandoned evil —
liberation is what is everywhere proclaimed.
"Evil exists in a mind that has not gone before" —
such a statement is not well said.
When one has satisfied the teacher with joyful offerings of food,
if that one dies without having asked,
the accumulation of sin arises.
One does not see action performed
in seclusion, free from attachment.
And so forth.

Furthermore, the Blessed One declared:

One who plants pleasure gardens of groves,
one who builds bridges,
one who provides wells, cisterns, and bathing pools,
one who gives resting places —

And likewise:

One who gives land for the sake of a temple of Śakra (Indra),
generates merit as pure as Brahmā's,
and rejoices for an aeon in the higher realms.

And so forth, as spoken in the sūtra.

Regarding "from this body into other bodies" and what follows: "from this body" means from the affliction of suffering caused by aging and so forth. "Into other bodies" means transferring and passing into other bodies. What is it that does so? "The life-force," which means the self and the person. What is this life-force like? It is said to be subtle — extremely fine and beyond the range of the sense faculties. Viṣṇu also said:

Just as a person discards worn-out garments
and takes up other, new ones,
likewise, having abandoned an old body,
the self takes up other, new bodies.

This cannot be cut by weapons,
this cannot be burned by fire,
it cannot be drenched by water,
it cannot be dried out by wind.

And so on, as was explained. The word "said to be" indicates that this is merely a conventional worldly expression, for in ultimate truth there is no self.

If a self existed, it would be either permanent or impermanent. If it were permanent, it would only ever experience pleasure and would never fall into the faults of suffering and the like. Therefore, the self does not exist in any form whatsoever.

As for the phrase "the body having become other" — here, by the word "body," what is meant as the self's own substance is precisely the five aggregates. You yourself have declared, the text now connects, that there is no self — no such thing as a life-force that has become other than and separate from that body. This is what the Blessed One, the Buddha, declared.

And indeed it has been said: "All phenomena are without a life-force, without a sustaining principle, without a person," up to the words, "they amount to nothing more than a mass of conditioning formations." Having set aside the pride of self, and applying the designation merely to what has become the substance of the self among the five aggregates — in that sense of self as a conventional substance — the Blessed One did, in certain places, speak of it.

Regarding the verse "If one is slain in battle while enraged" and so forth: "while enraged" means having become anger itself. It is elaborated that a man slain on the battlefield, in the place of combat, will go to a happy realm. And it is said in this vein:

Divine maidens adorned with manifold ornaments
will come, and embracing one slain in battle,
will carry him away to the abode of the gods.

As for the phrase "O Protector, you" — this is a form of address. The phrase "the mind of that very moment" means the mind as it was at that very instant. To die with such a mind, it is taught and declared, is nothing other than a

lower rebirth.

And indeed it has been said:

One of wretched fortune who dies in anger
is declared by the wise to go to a lower realm in the next world.
For the time being, here in this life, no fame will accrue,
and in the world beyond, there will be no happiness either.

Now, regarding the verse beginning "When King Śyāmaśṛṅga is mentioned" and so forth: it is as follows. King Śyāmaśṛṅga set out to hunt deer. At that time, a sage named Subdue-the-Wicked, having transformed himself into the form of a deer, was experiencing the pleasures of desire together with a doe. Śyāmaśṛṅga, not recognizing him, shot him with an arrow. Immediately afterward, the sage resumed his own form, and, overpowered by fury, cursed him thus: "Just as, while I was enjoying pleasure, you caused me to pass to another world before I could experience that pleasure to the full, so likewise may you too die in the same way." The sage's wife likewise climbed atop a great pile of firewood and spoke words of curse, saying: "May your wife too, after you have died, climb upon the pyre built for your cremation." Śyāmaśṛṅga had two wives named Mādṛī and Kundī, and the king, out of fear of the curse, was unable to cohabit with them. At that time Kundī thought: I have obtained a secret spell from a sage of the lower realms, and with it I have already accomplished one desire of mine; yet it can still be made to accomplish desires up to four times. If the king gives his permission, I shall then perform the act of bearing a son. The king too thought: by what means might I have a son? He then went to a private place and told the king of this matter. Hearing this, the king was pleased and granted her his consent. She entered a chamber, recited the spell, and spoke: "Let the deity named Dharma come to unite with me." After some time Dharma came, and from their union was born a son named Steadfast in Battle. In the same way she summoned the wind deity, and from their union was born Jaya. In the same way she summoned Śakra, Indra, and from their union was born Siddhasiddhi. After some time, Mādṛī, who had no son, was tormented with grief,

saying, "I shall die," and lamenting in grief, she petitioned Kuntī with words of supplication: "Give me that spell just once. Perhaps then I too shall give birth to a son." Hearing this, Kuntī consulted the sage and gave her the spell. She too recited the spell and summoned the two divine physicians, the Aśvins. From her union with those two there were born simultaneously twins: one

divine, named Devavat, and the other named Kunāla. In time Kuntī's sage won a great battle on earth. He gave the kingdom to Yudhiṣṭhira, and taking his two wives and his sons, went to the mountain of a hundred peaks and dwelt there devoted to the holy life of celibacy. After he had lived the celibate life for a long time, he saw how beautiful Mādrī's form was, and desire arose in him. He thought: "It would be better to die than to live together without enjoying pleasure with her," and he began to live with her — and at that very moment his time passed away.

When all the great sages who were at that hermitage saw his plight, they bore the body of the now-protectorless man, along with Mādrī, Kuntī, and all five sons, to the dwelling of Yudhiṣṭhira. There they built a funeral pyre in the proper manner, placed him upon it with great ceremony, and Yudhiṣṭhira made offerings to the sage. Mādrī entrusted both her sons to Kuntī and cast herself upon the funeral pyre. Then in time the heroes — Steadfast in Battle and the others — gathered together at a training ground and studied the martial science of weaponry taught by Kṛpa, Droṇa, and the like. Gaining the enmity of Karṇa, the five sons of the sage were confined in the house of Rājagṛha. That very night they escaped and slew the demon Hiḍimba, and Bhīma took the demon's sister, by whom a son named Ghaṭotkaca was born. Then they departed and came to the single-chariot city, and on the road encountered Vyāsa, who encouraged them and granted them the highest boon of sovereignty and a wife. Then they went to that city and stayed four years in the house of a brahmin, and in order to benefit him they slew the demon Jalasvara and went to take possession of five cities. At the time of the kings' choosing of a husband, they obtained a wife named Draupadī, and the five brothers took her in common and stayed one year. Then they went to Indraprastha and obtained the kingdom. Having ruled the kingdom for twenty-nine years, they slew the king called Jarāsandha and others, performed the royal sacrifice, and then in the dice game with Steadfast in Battle and the others, they were defeated by a trick and lost the kingdom to the enemy. Then again they spent twelve years in the forest, returned and dwelt one year in the city of Virāṭa, and Bhīma slew Kīcaka. Then the account runs until they entered the battle of Kurukṣetra. Steadfast in Battle had eleven armies and the sage's sons numbered seven; all of those died in battle, and Steadfast in Battle became king. After ruling the kingdom for thirty-six years, in time he went to the divine realm of Viṣṇu, and Yudhiṣṭhira and all the sons of the sage, together with those who had been born as the children of the deity called

Dharma — all of them, their time came to pass. Now the account to be written here concerns how it was that children were born to the deity called Dharma.

There was a sage named Adorned who dwelt in a hermitage, abiding there in the wealth of ascetic practice. Not far from that place there was a great city, and thieves had stolen goods from it and then taken refuge in the dense forest thickets of that hermitage. Many of the king's men came and said to the sage, "Did you see any thieves?" He replied that he had not seen them. Then the king's men searched the dense forest thickets, found the thieves, seized them, and came back saying, "This sage is the one who hid them," and having arrested him, they presented him to the king, reporting all that had occurred. The king, enraged, declared him guilty and, in order to have him impaled on a stake, handed him over to those whose office was to carry out executions. They brought the sage to the place of execution, and there they gathered acacia and other kinds of wood — but all of it fled away and became invisible. Then they brought the wood of the flame tree, and that did not flee. So the executioners erected the stake and impaled the sage upon it. But in time, leaves grew from that tree, and they spread out and formed a bower beneath the sage's body, sheltering him from below; and the king, coming there and thinking to himself, "Surely this sage has done no wrong," took him down from the stake.

The sage, furious, went to the Dharma deity and said, "While I was living as I should, you let injustice go on for a long time and caused me to suffer. You have acted in a completely unreasonable way. Understand this plainly: what unreasonable thing have I done?" The Dharma deity replied, "It is certainly your own fault. In a previous life you caught a bee in a clump of grass and reeds, pushed it in from below its body, forced it out from the tip of its mouth, and flung it upward. This present suffering is the fruit of that action." The sage, hearing this and furious at having the fault laid upon himself, resolved to curse the Dharma deity: "Because you have done me, a brahmin sage, such great harm, may you be reborn as a yakṣa. Because you do not know the proper conduct of my way of life, may you be reborn in the commoner class. And because you have treated me as though I were not a noble person, may you be reborn as a dog."

By this curse of the sage, Dharma fell down to Jambudvīpa. For a time, as a commoner, he was reborn as a kinsman of the Śākya of the land of Kapilavastu. As a yakṣa he was born near the sage's hermitage — called the Grove of Longing — which was the abode of the original germ-drop of the

sage. As for the dog, it is explained here in its proper place. Then, passing from those births, he was born as a deity. It is heard in the world that ordinary people say: "Even just by uttering the names of the sons of the sage, one will come to accumulate great merit." And it is said:

A wise person, merely by holding in mind
the names of the sage's sons,
will without doubt come to possess
great and abundant merit.

The meaning of the phrase "by reciting" is: by recounting and bearing in mind their names and telling the stories associated with them. What is to be recited? The verse states "the sons of the sage" — since they are the sons of the royal sage, they are the sage's sons, namely Steadfast in Battle and the rest. The phrase "merit will result" means it will result in merit and so forth — the full account is extensive. Is it by reciting all of them together, or by reciting each one individually? The verse says "individually" — meaning one by one.

"One who travels where one ought not travel" — a kinsman's wife is not to be approached;

Those who travel there are utterly condemned in your own teaching, so indeed they travel where one ought not travel.

"The Desiccator, the Lord, the Near-Lord" — and so forth. The Desiccator is the son of the Pleiades. The Lord is Śakra (Indra). The Near-Lord is the son of the god of wealth. The Fierce One is the Great God (Śiva). The word "and so forth" encompasses the god of desire and the Lord of Hosts, and the like. "Fear" means being frightened oneself. "Threatening" means harming others. On account of these, weapons are ever carried in hand — thus: the Desiccator carries a short spear, the Lord carries a vajra, the Near-Lord carries a wheel, the Fierce One carries a trident, the god of desire carries a bow and arrows, and the Lord of Hosts carries an axe, and so forth. The stories of their fear and their threatening were told above where it says: "The elder pierced Viṣṇu with an arrow," and "The name of the Great God filled with desire," and "The Eared One who is hard to fight," and "The Viṣṇus were mottled black," and so forth; and below as well, where it says: "The youth toward his own maternal uncle," and "Knowing the fear caused by the elder," and "Viṣṇu toward the kinsmen and companions" — these are the very passages where such things are discussed.

"O great hero, you are free from intimidation" — knowing yourself to have no equal, you are free from fear; and "you do no threatening" means that, your being filled with great compassion, you do no harm to others. How this appears in the various birth-stories is to be applied here in the same way. The verse "You are not intimidated by anyone" and what follows expresses exactly this: "You" refers to the Sugata (the Well-Gone One, an epithet of the Buddha). "Not intimidated" means without fear or apprehension. By whom is one not frightened? By anyone — meaning by ascetics (śramaṇas) and brahmins and māras and Brahmā and the like who hold themselves superior in the world — because all causes of fear have been abandoned. Now, if one were to think: "In the world we see that those who are themselves unharmed and powerful generally harm others and cause suffering," then the answer showing that this does not apply to our Teacher is: "you do no threatening toward anyone" — and therefore, O Sugata, you alone, by not bearing weapons such as the trident and the like, are supremely exalted above beings such as Śiva and the rest. That is the meaning.

Here an objection is raised. If one has also heard that Śiva and the like have laid aside all weapons and practiced austerities in solitary places, and if one has also heard that the Sugata himself sometimes transformed into the guise of a yakṣa or a rākṣasa, bore weapons, and cut down others — are these not then equivalent? They are not equivalent. As for Śiva and Viṣṇu and the like, their conduct of being unable to subdue the afflictions in their own natural bodies is recorded in passages from the Vedas that they themselves accept as valid authority. As for the Blessed One the Buddha, for the sake of taming others he displayed from an emanated body, through the power of compassion, what appears to be conduct associated with aversion and the like. How then could they be equivalent? If one were to reply: "Śiva and the like also display what appears to be conduct associated with afflictions through an emanated body, whereas their natural body is itself the quelling of afflictions" — well, if that were the case there would be no dispute. However, it would then be in contradiction with what appears in your own texts — for example, that the Great God Śiva with his very own natural body killed Brahmā, and that through Viṣṇu's intention of aversion he destroyed Śravaṇa — and so forth. These passages directly contradict such a claim.

"The speaker — words possessed of affliction" — and so forth:

"The speaker" is the one who speaks or expresses. That very speaker is possessed of afflictions, being associated with the three afflictions that

torment through clinging to one's own side with partiality, through aversion toward the side of others, and through grasping at self in all circumstances. "Words composed by that speaker" are those words — namely, the Vedas and so forth. Now since they are both the Vedas and so forth and also words, they are the words of the Vedas and so forth — that is, the Vedas of formulated expression and the like. By the word "and so forth," one should take the legends composed by the mendicants, the introductions of the Joymakers composed by Crogmar, and similar texts.

Even if one were to grant that the legends of the mendicants and so forth are indeed words composed by a person, one might still object: "The Vedas are the cause of all faults, and since they were not composed by a person, how could they be the words of a person?" This is utterly beside the point. For the Vedas too are the words of a person, since they arose from the conditioning activity of persons. This can be understood from statements such as "just as the introductions of the Joymakers" and so forth. Let us set aside the elaboration of this matter for now.

"For the most part, there are contradictions above and below" — "for the most part" means in many places. "Contradictions above and below" means that the words earlier and later in the text are mutually undermining. The reason intended is that the speaker is possessed of afflictions. The intermediate words — meaning "in your speech there is no contradiction" — are taken as an implicit inclusion, like the example of "a pot of yogurt."

If one asks how it is evident that there is no contradiction, the text says "it is the speech of the omniscient one" — meaning that because it is the speech of one who, through the exhaustion of both afflictive obscurations and cognitive obscurations, has gained mastery over all objects of knowledge.

"The treatises of others" refers to those expounded by the Jains — by the naked ascetics, the ash-smeared ones, and the like — along with the Sāṃkhyas, the Naiyāyikas, and the rest. "Others" means all others of whatever extent there may be.

"For the most part, there are contradictions earlier and later" — for example, the Sāṃkhyas assert that the primal principle (Skt. *pradhāna*) is permanent while also asserting that very same principle to be the cause of everything, which is deeply contradictory since something permanent cannot become a cause. The Naiyāyikas say that the self is something inert and also a subject who enjoys objects, which is equally contradictory. The Vedists assert that the

Vedas constitute the activity of composition and yet were also not composed by a person. Furthermore, those great gods such as Viṣṇu and the Sovereign Lord — claiming all the while to be omniscient — are said to have entered into incalculable ruin and then, in regret, to have entered upon the means of removing that ruin. There are many such statements that, if the Sugatas were to see them, would move them to laughter.

"But your own textual tradition" — that is, the textual tradition of the three scriptural collections spoken by you, the Sugata — "is free of flaw at beginning, middle, and end." This means that the words spoken at the beginning are not undermined by the words spoken in the middle and at the end; and likewise, what is spoken in the middle and at the end is not undermined by what comes before and after; nor does any reasoning damage any word as it stands in its own nature. Alternatively, "beginning, middle, and end" may be taken to mean that during the stages of hearing, reflection, and meditation, reasoning causes no damage — and therefore it is free of flaw. This, however, departs somewhat too far from the literal meaning of the words.

"Those who wish to teach the Dharma ought not to impart the suchness of genuine reality to persons of common lineage" — that is, to individuals of inferior estimation who wish to speak Dharma. To the minds of common folk, the genuine and unerring suchness should not be given, for they are not suitable vessels for the teaching. It is explained that if the Vedas are recited to common folk, one falls into hell.

Furthermore, were the reason for such teaching to become universally available to the common folk and all other classes alike, the brahmins would no longer be held in special reverence by others — and it was out of jealousy, therefore, that they framed it in those terms.

The verse reads: "You, O Sugata, even to the outcastes —" Here "outcastes" is used by way of proximate example, indicating those without caste standing, such as cobblers, fishermen, and the like. The particle "even" gathers in also the warrior class (kṣatriyas) and all other estates. The verse continues: "Out of compassion you teach the sacred Dharma." The meaning is: out of compassion alone — not for the sake of fame or gain — you give the sacred Dharma. As it is said:

Just as a mother feels a special anguish
for a child who has fallen ill,

so too the bodhisattva cherishes
with special love those who are not yet noble.

On the phrase "a fine and excellent tree" and what follows: it is both a tree and excellent, hence a fine tree — one that is fully endowed with leaves, blossoms, and fruit. "Having cast aside" means "having discarded." "The bad" refers to trees such as the eraṇḍa and the like, which no one with discernment would choose to rely upon.

Applying this same image to its intended meaning: "one who has attained freedom from attachment" is used by way of proximate example, meaning take it to indicate one who has attained the Dharma of complete liberation from all afflictions. While you, the Sugata, who possesses that very quality, remain present — what wise person would bow down and pay homage to other teachers, such as Sāṃkhya masters (tīrthikas) and flesh-eaters and the like, sunk as they are in the swamp of affliction? That is the meaning: no wise person would do so.

On the phrase "while the Sāṃkhya master indulges in the sense-objects" — "Sāṃkhya master" refers to the teacher of the Sāṃkhya school. "Indulging in sense-objects" means that even while enjoying sensory pleasures such as form and the rest, one can come to see through gnosis the genuine suchness of reality. This was also explained above in the passage beginning, "The Sāṃkhya's own defining characteristic."

"So it is said" is a word of dissatisfaction, meaning: "let it be known as such." The phrase "you who are free of sin" is a form of address, referring to you, the Sugata, in whom all non-virtue has been exhausted. The line "from utter affliction, how can there be liberation, as you declared?" — the phrase "utter affliction" is to be understood in its fuller, multi-syllabic sense, meaning a mind in which thorough affliction is present. Liberation is nirvāṇa, the passing beyond all suffering. "How can there be?" is a word of negation, meaning: there cannot be. "As you declared" means as the Blessed One taught — for example, as it appears in the sūtras: "To depend upon the five strands of sensual pleasure becomes an obstructing factor."

On the verse beginning "The collected masses of merit that have been performed" — "merit" refers to things such as the meritorious entity arising from generosity and the like. "Performed" means what has been deliberately accumulated through body, speech, and mind. "Collected masses" means

what has been accomplished in abundance. What the Blessed One taught regarding the thorough dedication of all these to sentient beings is found at length in passages such as: "All roots of virtue connected with the three times, having been held in common with all sentient beings, are to be thoroughly dedicated to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening." Nothing even approaching such a teaching is to be found in any of the treatises of the other schools — those of the Sāṃkhyas, the flesh-eaters, and the rest.

On the verse beginning "To images of gods and to burnt offerings" — "images of gods" refers to likenesses of Īśvara (Śiva), Umā, and the like. "Burnt offerings" refers to sacrificial offerings involving the slaughter of humans, horses, and the like. The particle "to" is a dative marker, applied to both ends of the compound. When construed as "killing sentient beings for the sake of divine images," it becomes a locative of the object; when construed as "killing sentient beings for burnt offerings,"

it becomes a seventh of the time. The manner of killing is also described in the Vedic scriptures: "At the time of the intermediate period, six or seven animals must be joined together. If they are of the pure breed of horses, that is so; if not, three animals will suffice. To each householder, sixteen and sixteen animals are given. According to the proper rite, the sacrificial post is established, and between them seventeen are to be offered." And further: "For a brahmin, a brahmin is killed; for a kṣatriya, a kṣatriya; for the merchant class, a lord of the lineage; and for ascetics, one of the common people." Such and similar passages are what worldly people regard as Dharma.

As for the verse "Your teaching is to be censured for that" — this means: those very things are a censure of your teaching, O Sugata. For it is extensively taught, as in the passage beginning "The karmic maturation of the act of killing is the hells and so forth." Here one might object: "Killing in general may indeed not be Dharma; but killing performed with the full ritual procedure arising from the Vedas at the time of a burnt offering — surely that is Dharma." This is not so. Whatever conduct perpetually harms living beings — whether it arises from the Vedas, or is proclaimed by a sage, or occurs at the time of a burnt offering — no dharmic nature whatsoever exists in such a mode of conduct; it is simply absent. Why? Because "Dharma" (dharma) is so called by virtue of upholding beings by preventing their fall into the lower realms, or by conferring happiness after passing on; and human sacrifice and the like are the very opposite of that. How so? Because they are harmful to others — just as the work of an outcaste is harmful. In the same way, when the

great sage Vyāsa was praising burnt offerings, his son Śuka said: "Having erected a sacrificial post and slaughtered cattle, making mud with their blood — if by that one might attain the higher realms, then please tell us: who is it that goes to hell?" So the saying goes. Therefore, O Blessed One, to say nothing of causing harm to others, let it be proclaimed that you yourself, through your own life, protected sentient beings well — with the Jātaka tale of the elephant and the rest cited as illustrations.

If the ritual of burnt offerings is not valid as Dharma, then one might ask: "Explain what, then, is the genuine, unmistakable Dharma." The reply follows with the verse beginning "You were born into the royal Śākya lineage." Here "Śākya" refers to the lineage of those who are the supreme ones among the householder clans. The account begins with the phrase "honored by many kings." After a royal succession of one hundred thousand years, ten thousand years, nine thousand years, four hundred years, and eighty-nine additional years had passed, in the city called Grdhrakūṭa — no, in a city called "Possessor of the Boat" — there arose a king named "Sugarcane," a noble-born man. He had five sons: Arrow-face, Elephant-tamer-in-hand, Ankle-braceleted, and Rejoicing-in-the-kingdom. At that time, the four took hold of the city — yellow and grey — and because they were exceedingly bold, they became known as "Śākya," meaning "the capable ones." Because the Blessed One descends from that lineage, he is of the royal Śākya lineage. Being born into it means that he took birth there with full intention. "Truthful" means that his essential nature is unmistakable. "Non-deceptive" means that his conduct generates confidence in those who enter. "Dwelling in the holy life" means that he has sealed the gates of the senses. "Tamed" means that signs and conceptual thought have been pacified. "Endowed with love" means that he is engaged in benefiting others. A mode such as that is, it should be understood, your sublime Dharma — and is certainly not harm or injury to those nearby. That is the meaning.

As for the verse beginning "Even one versed in all the Vedas" and so forth — one who is versed in all the Vedas, being learned and so on, still teaches that when an enemy comes in battle, he is to be killed. And this was stated above —

"Slain in battle by one acting in rage" — as was stated above. You the Sugata have taught that even toward an enemy one should have only compassion; this is to be taken as the illustrative story of the man who spoke with patience.

As for the verse beginning "The youth, his maternal uncle" and so on — from the ancient tale of Śkembyedpa, the following was heard. In the snowy mountains there were two sons named Nyachen and Ngurpa. Mount Ngurpa was exceedingly majestic and beautiful, having suppressed even Mount Meru and dwelling in surpassing splendor; and being jealous, he gave no opportunity to any accomplished being whatsoever. Thereupon the accomplished gods thought: "How shall we ever come to dwell there and enjoy sensual pleasures?" — and they became filled with desire. The youth went to where Mount Tise was being praised and made a request: "By whatever means, bring it about that we may enjoy sensual pleasures together with our wives at Mount Durpa." The youth reflected:

To turn away another's entreaty
is something worthy of reproach even if one's life is at stake.
Therefore I shall now exert myself fully
in this very task.

Having thought this, he went and with great homage made a request to Mount Durpa: "I ask that you carry out one thing for me without fail." Durpa replied: "What is it?" The youth said: "Show kindness to the accomplished ones, so that they may find opportunity." The moment he had spoken, Durpa's face blazed with wrathful arrogance, his brow knit in a frown, and he declared: "I will grant opportunity to no one whatsoever." The youth tried many kinds of effort but did not accomplish his aim, and at that point he set about fighting with Durpa. This conversation was heard by the goddess Umā, and fearing harm might come to her son, she was filled with anguish, pressed her hands to her cheeks, and sat in grief, thinking: "From this great disturbance that has arisen, will all three worlds not be thrown into turmoil?" Mount Tise, Mount Sahya, Vindhya, the Malaya range, and other mountains all went there and spoke, yet they were unable to bring that quarrel to peace. Then the youth, stirred by a wrathful spirit and with an angry mind, not reflecting carefully, hurled his spear thinking "With this I can shatter him," and the furious youth drove it so that Mount Durpa was split into two pieces. That place then became a great valley, and the knowledge-holders (vidyādhara) with their wives freely enjoyed sensual pleasures there to their hearts' content.

"The youth" is Kārttikeya. "His maternal uncle" is Mount Durpa, who is his mother's brother. As for what he split him with — "with a spear" is stated, meaning a single-pointed spear. "Split" means he cut him into two pieces. "A celebrated account was heard" means that this was heard as a well-known

tale. "The great hero" is an address, for being possessed of great valor he is called the great hero. "You" refers to the Blessed One. "The web of afflictions" refers to those to be abandoned by the path of seeing and the path of meditation — this is the meaning of "the assembly of latent tendencies." As for what was done to that assembly of afflictions — "severed" is stated, meaning utterly defeated, shattered, and abandoned. And by what were they severed and exhausted? — "by the weapon of wisdom" is stated, meaning by the spear of gnosis. This too the Blessed One declared: "By means of a mind like lightning and a vajra-like meditative absorption, the assembly of afflictions was slain." As for the verse beginning "Viṣṇu, from his own palace's side" and so on — because it is the flank of his own palace, it is his own flank — this is the meaning of "the assembly of the retinue of the consort."

"Cannot fully protect" means: is unable to fully guard. By whom is one unable? By Viṣṇu. The tale to be told here has already been explained in the passage beginning "The Elder pierced Viṣṇu with an arrow."

"O Lord, you" is a form of address. "All sentient beings" means those belonging to the three realms, and "for their protection" means acting for their benefit and welfare. "Always striving" means that at all times, continuously, he strives and exerts himself — as in the teaching that three times by day and three times by night the buddha surveys the worlds with his buddha-eye, asking: "Who is flourishing? Who is declining?"

Regarding the verse beginning "Having known the terror conjured by the Elder," the following story is to be heard: There was a certain asura who, by practising extreme austerities, obtained from the Great Brahmā the supreme boon of becoming lord over the three worlds. Having heard that Viṣṇu wished to defeat everyone, he thought: "Therefore I shall first destroy him; once he is destroyed, I shall, without obstruction, conquer and subdue the three levels of existence." And so he set to work to slay Viṣṇu. When he heard that Viṣṇu had collapsed and fallen to ruin, he hurled a great club from a great distance and then followed close behind it. But Viṣṇu, upon hearing the sound of the club being hurled, understood that it was coming, and in terror of death he abandoned his ruined state and went to the city of many gates that lies within the ocean.

The terror is the one conjured by the Elder — therefore it is called "terror conjured by the Elder." "Knew" means comprehended. By whom? By Viṣṇu. What did he abandon? His ruined state — meaning he abandoned and forsook

that city of ruin.

Regarding the line "O Sage, you — whatever it is from which you cause terror and fear" — "O Sage, you" is a form of address. "From which you cause terror and fear" means: that which produces terror and dread. "There is no such sentient being" means: throughout all three worlds there is no being of that kind whatsoever. The Sūtra of Bakula is to be cited here as an example, where it is stated at length that there is no being capable of causing a Tathāgata to tremble with fear.

Regarding the passage beginning "By Viṣṇu" — "by Viṣṇu" means "through Viṣṇu having become deluded," for were it not for bewilderment and the rest, the sages would not have rendered service that was unworthy of them, and so they would not have come to ruin in those circumstances. "The retinue of kinsmen" refers to the Viṣṇu-kinsmen — those who were ruined and thrown into confusion. The tale to be told here is written in the passage beginning "The Elder pierced Viṣṇu with an arrow."

"And you, the Blessed One — all the retinue of kinsmen" means the entire company of relatives. "From saṃsāra" means from the prison of conditioned existence. "Liberated" means: he caused them to attain nirvāṇa. Here one should apply the whole account — the recognition of excellence through a meal of groats and so forth at the meeting of father and son, and the journey to the realm of the Thirty-Three gods in order to teach the Dharma to his mother, and everything else of that kind.

Regarding the passage beginning "According to the scriptural systems of other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)" — "of other" means those who are outside this teaching. "Scriptural systems" means the established philosophical tenets. "In whatever ways" is a repetition expressing "to whatever extent and in whatever manner." "Examined and deliberated" means investigated and analyzed.

The phrase "in such and such a way" means "to whatever extent and in whatever manner." The phrase "to you, O Protector" means "addressing you." The line "my mind has come to have faith" means that one has come to be endowed with faith and to possess a clear and glad mind.

Regarding the passage beginning "Just as those who are not omniscient" — the word "just as" indicates the nature of the fault described previously, showing that whoever holds a mind captured, dominated, and drawn along by it will think in the following way. "Those who are not omniscient" means those who are not omniscience itself, namely the brahmins in their yellow robes and

so forth. The philosophical tenets established by them are therefore called the philosophical tenets of the non-omniscient. Because this is their fault, it is the flaw of the philosophical tenets of the non-omniscient. "Those of confused thought" means the childish — those who lack discernment are called persons of confused thought. Regarding the line "yet even you, the faultless Teacher, they do not perceive" — "faultless" means having abandoned without remainder all the faults of the afflictions together with their habitual tendencies. "Teacher" means one who acts as teacher to gods and humans. "You" refers to the buddha, the Blessed One. "Do not perceive" means do not understand.

Regarding the passage beginning "The world with its gods and brahmins" — the non-Buddhists of this world say this: "This son of the Śākyas is hostile to the gods, to brahmins, and to the Vedas." Yet those who themselves create such faults neither think about this as it truly is nor come to understand it. And indeed it is like this: under the sway of their lack of faith, whatever worldly beings recall or conceptually think about, they, without examining the beginning and end of those things, superimpose upon them in words. That very Śākya, however, has examined the beginning and the end of those things, has known them to be without connection and without essence, and teaches accordingly — and this does not make him at fault. It is this world, being as it is, that is at fault.

Furthermore, regarding the objection "why should beings like us delight in your teaching?" — the passage beginning "Because your teaching" is stated in reply. "Because" means "for the reason that." "Your teaching" means the scriptures of the buddha, the Blessed One. "Happiness" refers either to the happiness of liberation or to the happiness of higher realms and so forth. "Happiness itself" means through the path itself, which is a concordant means. "Causes to attain" means causes to obtain. "For that reason" means for that very purpose. "Lion of speech" is an address, meaning "you who are a lion of speech." "Scriptural system" means the teaching, and it is in that that one delights. Who delights? The line "these wanderers" is stated — beings like us. "Delighting" means being pleased and devoted.

Now, in order to dedicate the merit arising from this praise, the passage beginning "your qualities, which are perfect" is stated. "Your" refers to the Tathāgata's. "Qualities" means the abandonment of the afflictions and so forth. "Perfect" means having come to possess them without doubt. "In the manner described" means in the manner explained above. "Having

proclaimed" means having spoken. "I" refers to the one who composes the praise. "Whatever merit" means whatever wholesome conduct there is.

"Obtained" means arisen or found. "The world of beings" means all the worlds of sentient beings. "May they become like you" means: may they become like you, the buddha, the Blessed One — that is, may they attain the primordial wisdom of omniscience.

Thus from that, and having accumulated accordingly,
Adorned by such karma in like manner,
With compassion for sentient beings, extensively explained,
This armor of wisdom was made.

Knowing that those beings possess such a lineage,
Ascertaining the very reality of the Sage's accumulation of qualities,
Though the faults that emerge are many, having abandoned them purely —
How may these worlds turn toward the Sugata?

Whatever merit I have done, with faith as the foremost,
Born well, outshining the rays of the moon —
By that merit, may the worlds obscured by the thick darkness of delusion
Swiftly obtain the unstained medicine of the sky of mind.

Here ends the extensive commentary on "The Praise Called Transcendent,"
the Praise of the Tathāgata, composed by the master Mahāvratins, having
arisen in the northern transmission, composed by the master Prajñāvarman of
the land of Bhaṅgala.

Translated and revised by the Indian abbot, the paṇḍita Jārandhana, and the
great translator-monk Rinchen Zangpo, and established in final form.

He who bears the moon's crest and yellow robes, who brings joy —
The Vedic maker, the gladdener, the fort-dweller,
The flourishing, the royal seer, and the son of the earth,
The Sage, foot-marked, spike-sharp, following the demigods —
Born of the lineage of the Protector, maker of day,
The teacher of the three realms, that king of the Śākyas —
Praised in a manner not fabricated, as his liberation truly is,
The commentary on that praise is here completed.

By this virtue, wandering through the realm of existence,
Having strayed thick with the grasping at self —
May I become the Victor, the sun,

Dispeller of the darkness of the tīrthikas.

Here ends the extensive commentary on the Transcendent Praise, from the work of the master Prajñāvarman. Among the intervening verses, twelve verses —

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit title Viśeṣastava-nāma-ṭīkā refers to the commentary (ṭīkā) on the Viśeṣastava, the "Praise Called Supremely Exalted," a celebrated hymn attributed to Mātṛceta. The Tibetan narrative here is the prologue to this commentary, explaining the legendary circumstances of Mātṛceta's conversion from Śaiva devotion to Buddhism. The name rendered "Mātṛceta" (Tib. མ་ཏྲ་ཅེ་ཏ་) is the standard identification in the commentarial tradition. "Sukhakara" (Tib. སུ་ཁ་ཀ་ར་) is the name of his brother. The final two lines of verse are the opening of the Blessed One's praise as quoted or alluded to by the Great God, and the passage breaks off mid-stanza.
- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end with an unresolved alternative explanation beginning "Alternatively, even though this world does not delight in faults as such —" This is not an error in translation but reflects the passage as given, which ends mid-thought. The continuation presumably explains how attachment to teachers perceived as qualified leads one to mistake their faults for virtues.
- The verse near the end is a quotation from an outside source, likely a non-Buddhist text or a polemical citation; the fragment breaks off mid-sentence at the last two lines, as the Tibetan passage itself ends in the middle of a verse. The final couplet is therefore rendered as a fragment consistent with the source text's abrupt ending.
- The story of Sundhā and Upasundhā is a well-known Indian narrative; in the Mahābhārata they are the demon brothers Sunda and Upasunda destroyed by the apsarā Tilottamā, who is here called Tilalepī, meaning roughly "the one smeared or composed of sesame seeds," reflecting the motif of gods contributing a sesame-seed of radiance each to form her. The passage presupposes this narrative background without fully narrating it, and the translation follows the Tibetan's abbreviated account accordingly.

The phrase rendered "the supreme Bindu maiden" translates Tibetan Thig le'i mchog ma, which most likely corresponds to Sanskrit Tilottamā; "bindu" and "tila" are bridged by the commentary's own gloss linking the sesame-seed image to her creation. This rendering preserves the Tibetan textual term while the note clarifies the Sanskrit referent.

- The term rendered "Ngurpa" appears to be a proper name or epithet applied to Śiva in his half-female form (Ardhanārīśvara). The Tibetan རྒྱུ་པ་ is not fully transparent; it may be a phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit term or a descriptive epithet meaning something like "the anguished one" or "the lamenting one," applied here to the figure who strains but cannot prevail. The precise etymology is uncertain.

The passage about Viṣṇu's kinsmen and the iron pestle is a retelling of the well-known Yāda destruction narrative from the Mahābhārata and Purāṇas, here recast in a polemical Buddhist frame.

- The text gives explicit etymological glosses on several phrases, moving from narrative into commentary mode mid-passage. These are preserved as the text itself presents them, since the Tibetan author is commenting on a verse that has been cited. The phrase rendered "son of

Brahmā" for Sred med kyi bu (literally "son of the desireless one") is an established epithet of Viṣṇu in the Tibetan tradition, identifying him as born from Brahmā, who is called "the desireless one."

- The story of Viṣṇu's three strides and his defeat of the asura king Balin is the Vāmana myth from Hindu tradition, well known in Indian literature; the text uses it as an illustrative example to contrast the Blessed One's omniscience with Viṣṇu's resort to deception. The "sūtra of the Master holding a sword" cited as a parallel example has not been identified with certainty in extant canonical literature.

- The sūtra quotation near the end of the passage about the seven forms of sexual connection corresponds to a text found in the Pāli canon as well as in Sanskrit and Chinese parallels — the Saptasamyojanīya-sūtra or a related discourse. The verse breaks off mid-sentence in the source passage.

- The phrase rendered "five qualities of sensory desire" refers to the standard Buddhist enumeration of the five strands of sensual pleasure, namely pleasant forms, sounds, scents, tastes, and tactile objects associated with the five senses of the desire realm.

The name "Aśolā" is a transliteration of the Tibetan "bShol med ma," which in the mythological context appears to be a proper name for Ahalyā, the wife of the sage Gautama in the well-known Indian narrative of Indra's seduction of her. The Tibetan rendering here likely represents Ahalyā under a slightly variant form, and the identification with that tradition is almost certain.

- The name rendered "Aśolā" in the preceding passage is here consistent. The story of Gautama the sage, Śakra, and Aśolā is a well-known episode in Indian mythological literature; the commentary is treating it as background for a verse about Śakra's thousand eyes. The passage about Rāhu and Viṣṇu reflects the standard Purāṇic account of the churning of the ocean. The king "Daśaratha of the thirty-three-chariot company" is a slightly unusual epithet; the Tibetan reads "king of thirty-three chariots," which may be a variant reference to Daśaratha's connection with the Trāyastriṃśa gods or simply a royal epithet. The names Priyaka and Vastranemin correspond to known characters in the Rāmāyaṇa cycle as read through Buddhist sources, where Priyaka corresponds to Rāma.

- The verse attributed to Bhīṣma likely refers to a Mahābhārata episode where Bhīṣma describes the scale of ritual sacrifice. The numbers given — seven thousand in water and eleven thousand in fire — refer to the number of animals offered in various sacrificial rites. The precise source context is not fully certain from the Tibetan alone.

The "Sūtra of the Dharma-King" cited in the passage is an unidentified canonical reference not immediately traceable to a standard canonical text by this title; it may be an alternative name for a known sūtra or a loose citation.

- The sūtra citation attributed to the Blessed One names the "forest hermitage of Mataka" (Ma-ta-ka'i dgon-pa). This appears to refer to a specific site known from the Pāli/Sanskrit textual tradition, possibly the Mātāṅga or a related hermitage name; the identification is not entirely certain but is not consequential for the doctrinal sense.

The final sentence breaks off mid-clause at the end of the passage ("and the sages' wives"). This is an artifact of the source excerpt ending mid-sentence; the translation renders it faithfully.

- The reference to "the master Aśvaghoṣa" renders the Tibetan slob dpon dpa' bo, which is a standard Tibetan rendering of Aśvaghoṣa, the celebrated Sanskrit poet and Buddhist philosopher. The verse attributed to him in this context has no precisely identified canonical locus.

The phrase "the mark" throughout renders *mtshan*, which in this passage oscillates between the specific anatomical sense of "phallus" and the ritual sense of "symbolic emblem" or "liṅga," as context demands; both senses are retained without disambiguation in the translation body since the text exploits the double meaning deliberately.

- The phrase rendered "courage of heart, enters into this nature possessing the forms of activity and inertia" is a compressed paraphrase of Sāṃkhya metaphysics: the "nature" here is *prakṛti*, and "activity and inertia" render the *guṇas* *rajas* and *tamas*. The verse-fragment is quoted from a Sāṃkhya source, likely a paraphrase of principles found in texts like the *Sāṃkhyakārikā*; the twenty-five realities are the classical Sāṃkhya *tattvas*.

The divine daughter's name, rendered here as "Vasantī" (Spring-Bearer), appears in Tibetan as *dpyid ldan ma*, literally "she who possesses spring." This may correspond to a Sanskrit name *Vasantī* or *Vasantatilakā*; the exact Sanskrit original is uncertain but the semantic meaning is clear.

- The verse attributed to the Elder *Ratnaketu* follows a slightly irregular metre in the Tibetan and the rendering preserves the sense rather than attempting a strict syllabic equivalence.

The attribution to "the master Aśvaghoṣa" (Tibetan: *slob dpon rta skad*) is the standard identification of this name in the commentarial tradition; the quoted verse has not been traced to a surviving Sanskrit source with certainty, but the attribution itself is unambiguous in the text.

- The passage contains a polemical summary of several non-Buddhist positions. The "curds and milk" argument is a *reductio* of a Sāṃkhya-style causal reasoning (*satkāryavāda* or related inference schemes), and the translation preserves the logical structure rather than smoothing it into an abstract paraphrase. The argument about the self inferred from observable function reflects a *Nyāya* or *Vaiśeṣika* style of inference; this is rendered straightforwardly.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, so the translation ends correspondingly mid-sentence.

- The name rendered as "Vistarapuṣpa" for བུ་ཤིང་པུ་སྐུ་ is a reconstructed Sanskrit equivalent of the Tibetan ("son of the one who flourished / expanded"), used here as a sage's name; the Tibetan is literally "son of Gyaspa." The identification is uncertain and no Sanskrit source has been located; this is a narrative figure appearing in a non-Buddhist cosmological legend being cited for comparative purposes.

The verse attributed to Ācārya Aśvaghoṣa (ཁ་ཤོག་གི་སྐུ་, "Horse-voice") is a close parallel to verses found in the *Buddhacarita*; the attribution is accepted here as given by the text.

The phrase rendered "liberation brings forth another transformation" opens the next section and is taken as a section heading verse; its full explication appears to follow in the text beyond this passage.

- The phrase rendered "the man of the Vṛṣṇi clan" translates a term that literally refers to someone connected to *Vṛṣṇi* — the *Vṛṣṇis* being a subclan of the *Yādavas* prominent in the *Mahābhārata* — consistent with the narrative context following the battle of *Bhārata*. The identification is contextually secure.

The term rendered "the battle of Bhārata" refers to the *Mahābhārata* war, a standard Tibetan designation for that conflict.

- The name rendered "Brahmadatta" translates the Tibetan བླ་མ་བླ་མ་ལྷ་མོ་, a standard Tibetan rendering of the Sanskrit *Brahmadatta*. The name རྒྱུ་མོ་ (daughter of *Kuntibhoja*) is rendered as "Kuntī," her standard Sanskrit name. The sage རྒྱུ་མོ་ (Durāśaya, "dwelling in ill intent" or similar) is rendered by approximate Sanskrit back-formation; the Tibetan is literally "bad dwelling-place" and likely corresponds to a Sanskrit name such as *Durāśraya*. The passage

• The name rendered as "Ānanda the Foe-Warrior" translates the Tibetan phrase meaning "he who delights in fighting enemies on the great mountain" — the Tibetan is a descriptive epithet corresponding to the Sanskrit name Paraśurāma in the Mahābhārata context, though the Tibetan text does not give the Sanskrit name explicitly. Readers familiar with the epic will recognize this figure. The phrase rendered "Sred-sgrub" is a Tibetan proper name left as-is because no Sanskrit equivalent is supplied in the text; in the Mahābhārata context this would correspond to a character in the Karna narrative. The final verse is incomplete as the passage breaks off mid-stanza.

• The name "Siddhasādhaka" (Tib. srid sgrub) appears to function as an epithet meaning "one who accomplishes existence" or possibly a proper name; the same figure appears in both the battle narrative and the Jāmadagni story, which is consistent with the Paraśurāma cycle of the Mahābhārata. The "Dusty One" (Tib. rdul can ma) corresponds to the figure known in Sanskrit sources as Reṇukā, the wife of Jamadagni, whose name means "she of the dust." The "Great Vision of Joy" sūtra reference is unclear and may refer to a specific Mahāyāna sūtra not immediately identifiable. The passage as a whole is a commentarial text explaining an earlier verse by drawing on Purāṇic narrative parallels.

- The term rendered "ratless" translates a Tibetan epithet of Ahalyā, wife of the sage Gautama. The Vedic and Purāṇic allusion concerns the myth of Ahalyā's seduction by Indra and subsequent curse; the "rat" designation for Ahalyā is a polemical, derogatory epithet used in a Vedic ritual context (the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa tradition). The passage is a Buddhist polemical commentary mocking the Vedic canon.

"Viṣṇu is the son of Brahma" — this is the text's own claim, which is theologically non-standard from a Hindu perspective; it reflects Buddhist polemical misreading or deliberate inversion of Brahmanical genealogy.

- The verse objection in the middle of this passage appears to be the Sāṃkhya interlocutor's counter-argument defending a permanent, all-cognizing self against the preceding critique. The translation preserves the argumentative structure accordingly.

The name translated as "Ulūka" renders the Tibetan "Gzegs zan" (literally "one who eats flesh"), which is a standard Tibetan rendering of the name Ulūka, the legendary founder of the Vaiśeṣika school. Similarly, "Kapila" is the founder of the Sāṃkhya school, and "Kāpila" refers to his followers.

- The twenty-five Jain teachers named here are identified as Ṛṣabha and Vṛddhi and the remaining masters of the Nirgrantha tradition; the Tibetan རྒྱལ་མཆོག་ (literally "foremost of the herd") is a standard rendering of the name Ṛṣabha, "Bull," the first Jain Tīrthaṅkara, and འཇམ་མཉམས་ renders Vṛddhi. The number twenty-five does not correspond to the standard Jain enumeration of twenty-four Tīrthaṅkaras; this may reflect a variant polemical tradition or a textual peculiarity worth noting.

The "Brahmins" in the final section are glossed as Mīmāṃsakas, which is consistent with the Mīmāṃsā doctrine of a permanent self as the agent behind Vedic ritual.

- The name Agata appears to be a proper name for a sage character in the narrative; it is left as given in the Tibetan. The story here draws on material parallel to the Sāgara-nāga myth from the Mahābhārata tradition, adapted into Buddhist polemic context. The figure rendered "Windfall" and "Earthly" represent the Tibetan names Rlung thob and Sa ldan respectively; these are transliterated meanings given as narrative names for the two asura brothers, and no standard Sanskrit equivalents are recoverable from the text alone. The sentence ends mid-narrative, as the passage itself breaks off; the translation follows the Tibetan text exactly to its end.

- The verse naming the seven rivers presents a textual crux. The Tibetan gives what appears to be a rough phonetic rendering of Sanskrit river names: *Sītā*, *Sindhu*, *Vakṣu* are recognizable; the fourth is the *Gaṅgā*; the remaining three — rendered here as *Hrī*, *Tsim*, and *Nalinī* — correspond approximately to the classical list of seven rivers flowing from Lake Anavatapta in Indian cosmological sources, though the exact Sanskrit originals for the middle two Tibetan phonemes (ཁྱི་ and ཐིམ་མེད་) are uncertain. *Nalinī* is the standard seventh river in such lists.

The phrase rendered "thirty thousand years of divine time" translates त्रिंशत्सहस्रवर्षा, literally "thirty thousand divine years," which in Indian cosmological reckoning represents an enormous span of human time, each divine year being three hundred and sixty human years.

- The passage is a dense commentarial exegesis on Sāṃkhya philosophy embedded in a narrative context about the Gaṅgā myth. The "principal" is the Sāṃkhya pradhāna or prakṛti; the "person" is puruṣa; the "three qualities" are the three guṇas: sattva (vitality), rajas (activity), and tamas (darkness). The "great one" is mahat; "pride" is ahaṃkāra; the "subtle essences" are tanmātras; and the enumeration of twenty-four realities plus the puruṣa as the twenty-fifth reflects the classical Sāṃkhya taxonomy. The Yellow Brahmin (Skt. Kapila) is the legendary founder of the Sāṃkhya school; the text is presenting this school's doctrines for purposes of later refutation or contextualisation. The verse quoted as a hymn of praise appears to be addressed to Viṣṇu or a buddha-figure and its precise source is uncertain.

- The verse attributed to "the elder Aśvaghōṣa" renders འཁོག་འཁོག་འཁོག་འཁོག་འཁོག་ as "the elder Aśvaghōṣa." The name འཁོག་འཁོག་ means "horse-sound / horse-voice," which is a standard Tibetan rendering of Aśvaghōṣa. However, attributing this specific verse to Aśvaghōṣa rather than to another figure of that name or a different author is the tradition's own ascription and has been preserved as given.

The reference to "Naitṛka" renders ལྟཱཱ་ཀ་, a Tibetan transcription of a name that likely corresponds to a specific non-Buddhist teacher; the exact Sanskrit original is not fully certain, but the name appears in the broader context of Sāṃkhya-related tīrthika teachings mentioned in the surrounding commentary.

- The verse quotation attributed to Viṣṇu is drawn from the Bhagavadgītā (2.22–23), which is

here introduced as a citation by Viṣṇu rather than by Kṛṣṇa; this reflects the Tibetan commentarial tradition's identification of the Gītā's speaker with Viṣṇu.

The citation attributed to the Blessed One with the vocative "Rohita" refers to the Rohitassa-sūta or its Sanskrit parallel, a well-known sūtra in which the Buddha teaches that the end of the world cannot be reached by physical travel.

- The names Śyāmaśṛṅga, Subdue-the-Wicked, Mādrī, Kundī, Steadfast in Battle, Jaya, and Siddhasiddhi are rendered from the Tibetan. Śyāmaśṛṅga and Mādrī correspond to the Mahābhārata figures Śyāmakarṇa and Mādrī respectively; the passage is a loose Tibetan retelling of the Pāṇḍava origin story. The sage's Tibetan name, Ngan-'dul, is translated as "Subdue-the-Wicked" for clarity. The sons' names — Brtan-pa and Srid-sgrub — are translated from their Tibetan meanings since no fixed Sanskrit equivalents are recoverable from the Tibetan alone.
- The passage is a condensed narrative summary of the Mahābhārata storyline. Several proper names are rendered phonetically from their Tibetan transliterations: Kṛpa, Droṇa, Karṇa, Hiḍimba, Ghaṭotkaca, Draupadī, Jarāsandha, Kīcaka, Kurukṣetra, Virāṭa, and Vyāsa, as these are recognizable Sanskrit names. The Tibetan "ལྷ་མོ་" literally means "the eared one" and is a recognized Tibetan translation of the name Karṇa. The phrase "city of a single chariot" renders the Tibetan's literal translation of Ekacakrā, the city by that name in the Mahābhārata. The "divine physicians, the Aśvins" renders "འཕྲིན་པ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" — the two divine physicians identified as the Aśvin twins. "Devavat" is a literal rendering of "འདྲེན་པ་" meaning "possessing god" or "god-like," which may be a variant name; the tradition identifies these twins as Nakula and Sahadeva, but the text preserves its own nomenclature and is translated accordingly.
- The phrase rendered "germ-drop" for "རྩ་འི་ཐིག་ལེ" (rtsa'i thig le) is a semi-technical term indicating a primal or seminal source-point, here associated with the sage's hermitage lineage. It may refer to a specific sacred site or founding hermitage rather than a physiological concept; the context is geographical-hagiographical.

The passage shifts into commentary mode near the end, glossing the verse that has just been quoted. The final sentence is mid-flow, commenting on a further verse about prohibited conduct. This is the natural break point of the passage.

- The figure "Śravaṇa" rendered from "ལྷ་མོ་" is literally "bad sound" or "ill repute" and likely refers to a figure or episode in Vaiṣṇava mythology where Viṣṇu destroys someone or something by name associated with inauspicious sound. The exact referent is not fully certain from context alone, but the translation "Śravaṇa" renders the name rather than the meaning to avoid over-interpretation.

The phrase "ལྷ་མོ་", rendered "carries an axe," literally means "holds an enemy-axe" or "holds a battle-axe"; this is the standard iconographic weapon of Gaṇeśa, the Lord of Hosts.

- The term rendered "the Joymakers" translates a phrase referring to a specific tradition or textual lineage; the precise referent is uncertain but likely indicates a class of literary or philosophical compositions attributed to a group or figure whose name carries the meaning of delight or joy. The Tibetan "Crogmar" appears to be a proper name of an author or school and is left as a phonetic rendering since its Sanskrit equivalent is not determinable from context alone.

The phrase rendered "legends composed by the mendicants" refers to literary compositions of the Jain tradition, specifically śramaṇa literature, as context makes clear.

- The eraṇḍa tree is the castor-oil plant, proverbially useless or unpleasant, a standard Indian literary image for something of no value. The contrast with a "fine tree" bearing leaves, blossoms, and fruit is a conventional simile for the Buddha's teaching versus those of rival schools.

The grammatical analysis of the dative particle "la" at the close of the passage is left mid-sentence in the source text, which breaks off at that point; the translation follows the Tibetan precisely and ends where the passage ends.

- The passage cites a verse attributed to Śuka, the son of Vyāsa, challenging the virtue of Vedic animal and human sacrifice. The verse is a well-known polemical quotation used in Buddhist critiques of the Vedic sacrificial tradition.

The account of the Śākya genealogy here is somewhat compressed and the city names and numerals as they appear in the Tibetan are difficult to reconcile with standard genealogical lists. The figure "Grdrhakūṭa" (Vulture Peak, Rājagṛha) does not fit the genealogical context; the Tibetan reads a city called "Possessor of the Boat" (ཡོ་ཁུ་ཁུ་ཁུ་ཁུ་), which likely corresponds to a place name in the Śākya origin myth — the reading is preserved as given.

- The tale of Śkembyedpa is presented as a frame narrative from an ancient story cycle used to illustrate a verse; the proper name "Śkembyedpa" appears to be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit original that cannot be recovered with certainty from the Tibetan alone. The youth identified at the close as Kārttikeya (the war god, son of Śiva and Umā) and the goddess Umā's role confirm this is a retelling from the Śaiva mythological corpus. Mount Durpa and Mount Tise (Kailāsa) are the principal peaks named; "Sahya," "Vindhya," and "Malaya" are the well-known Indian mountain ranges listed alongside them.
- The city "of many gates" translates རྒྱལ་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་མཛེས་ལྗོངས་, a name meaning literally "the gated city" or "city endowed with gates." This is a reference from the Mahābhārata tradition — the city Dvāravatī or a cognate mythological city — embedded in what is clearly a narrative gloss drawing on non-Buddhist epic sources. The Bakula sūtra reference (འཇིག་རྟེན་ལྗོངས་) is attested in the Pāli and Sanskrit traditions, though the specific framing here, that no being can terrify a Tathāgata, points to the fearlessness teachings in that corpus.
- The Tibetan term rendered "those in yellow robes and so forth" refers specifically to certain non-Buddhist ascetics identifiable by their ochre or yellow dress; the commentary uses this as an example of those who construct philosophical tenets while lacking omniscience.
- The verse beginning "He who bears the moon's crest" is a colophon verse by the Tibetan translator, Rinchen Zangpo, identifying a series of divine epithets that appear to allude to figures such as Śiva (moon-crested, yellow-robed), Viṣṇu (foot-marked), and others from the Brahmanical pantheon, deploying them as a rhetorical catalog to contrast with the Buddha as the true "Victor, maker of day." The list is deliberately allusive and the identifications are not all certain; they seem to serve as a foil, asserting that the Buddha surpasses all such figures. The final colophon line is incomplete as transmitted, breaking off mid-sentence with "among the intervening verses, twelve verses," indicating the passage continues beyond the given excerpt.

The name rendered "Mahāvratins" for བཤའ་བྱའི་འཁོར་ལོ་ is uncertain; བཤའ་བྱའི་འཁོར་ལོ་ is an unusual name and may be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name not yet fully identified. "Bhaṅgala" for བཤའ་བྱའི་འཁོར་ལོ་ is a tentative geographic identification.